

Company Operation and Management

第一单元 公司运作与管理

1.1 Teamwork

团队合作

1.1.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

incremental *adj.* 逐渐增长的, 递增的

accountability *n.* 有责任, 责任心

organizational performance 企业绩效

the bottom line 公司的实际收入, 底线

盈亏一览结算线 (原指公司财务报表上的底线, 盈亏一览结算线, 在财务报表中用此线标明净收益或净损失)

emergency room 急诊室

trauma *n.* 外伤, 损伤, 精神创伤

functional department 职能机构, 职能部门

be accountable for... 对……负有责任

creative innovation 创新改革, 创新发明

reward system 奖励制度

pay back 回报, 报偿

individuality *n.* 个性

independent thinking 独立的思想

group decision-making 集体决策

managerial skill 管理技能

coordinate *vt.* 使协调, 调整

interpersonal relationship 人际关系

mutual trust 相互信任

bring out the potentials 充分发挥潜能

closely-knit *adj.* (关系) 密切的

keep track of 跟踪, 追踪

time-consuming *adj.* 花费时间的

line manager 部门经理, 业务经理
(与行政经理相对)

pre-requisite *n.* 前提

team-building *n.* 团队建设

nurture *vt.* 培养, 教育, 发展

nurture team dynamics 培养团队活力

promote team spirit 提倡团队精神

drive team success 驱使团队成功

minimize *vt.* 将……减到最少, 最小化

inhibit *vt.* 约束, 抑止

liven up 使……有生气

training session 一场训练, 培训课期

rafting *n.* 漂流

rock climbing 攀岩

teammate *n.* 队友

impact *n.* 影响，效果

complementary *adj.* 补充的，互补的

revitalize *vt.* 使新生，给予新的活力

sense of responsibility 责任感

at hand （手头）现有的

overbearing *adj.* 专横的，傲慢的

go back on 收回，后悔

overly critical 过于挑剔，吹毛求疵

open-minded *adj.* 心胸开阔

title *n.* 头衔

common vision 共同目标

gauge *vt.* 估计，估算

trait *n.* （个人性格方面的）特征，显著的特点

commitment *n.* 敬业精神

interpersonal communication skills 人际
交往技能，亦作 interpersonal skills

address *vt.* 处理（事情）

creative innovation 创新精神

1.1.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

团队精神

在当今日趋激烈的竞争中，企业生存和发展壮大的能力取决于企业团队的集体竞争力。因此，培养一支充满协作精神的高效团队，是企业决策层的管理目标之一。要尽可能使团队成员享有共同的目标和期望，享有相近或类似的观念、信念、价值和行为规则，以形成一种共同的行为模式，团结共进、众志成城——这就是企业凝聚力的体现。

要使团队具有良好的作风和氛围，团队内部人际关系的和谐至关重要，团队成员之间要做到真诚待人、互敬互重、彼此宽容、彼此信任、相互关怀。每个成员都要从自我做起，齐心协力，共同打造出能力互补、同舟共济、责任共担、利益共享的团队精神。

在日常工作中要保持团队精神与凝聚力，沟通是一个重要环节。有了比较畅通的沟通渠道、频繁的信息交流，团队成员间就不会有压抑的感觉，工作就容易出成效，目标就能顺利实现。因此学会与他人沟通、学会与他人合作对每个员工都十分重要。然而，英语文化有着强调人的个性发展，鼓励个人奋斗、表现自我、实现自我价值的传统，于是各大公司企业高度重视团队建设，纷纷开办各种培训班，组织各种活动，让团队合作的理念深入人心。合作性的活动有利于发展人际交往和沟通能力，形成团队集体意识。通过团队合作，员工之间以各自的优势进行互补。一方面员工有机会充分发挥自己的才华，另一方面员工之间又形成一种合作的默契，推动整个创造性过程的发展。这样，企业的潜在创造力才能得到充分发挥，企业的整体目标才能顺利地实现。

1. 1. 3 Background Reading (相关背景阅读)

The Difference between a Work Group and a Real Team

The distinctions between a team and a work group are very important because the operating level of a group effects:

- (1) the ability of groups of people to contribute to their organization,
- (2) the levels of personal growth and satisfaction of group members,
- (3) the return on resources (time, talent, money, etc.) expended by the group,
- (4) the requirements for operating, growing and maintaining the group.

The Difference between a Work Group and a Real Team

Fundamental factors that distinguish between work groups and real teams are the presence or absence of:

- (1) an incremental performance need or opportunity,
- (2) true interdependence and,
- (3) real shared accountability.

The best single criterion to use for determining whether a team or a work group is the best choice for a given situation is this: Does an incremental performance need or opportunity exist? Put another way, is there a need/opportunity to make a significant difference in organizational performance? It is important to select the right kind of group, either work group or team, for each situation. One is not inherently better than the other. If a significant performance need or opportunity exists, then a team is potentially a better choice. If it does not, then a work group is preferable. Teams have greater performance potential, but require more development and maintenance than work groups. It comes down to an issue of return on investment. Remember also that return is measured not only in dollars, but in quality of work life and other intangibles which will ultimately, though not always immediately, effect the bottom line.

Examples of situations where real teams are needed are sports teams or emergency room trauma teams. For both of these, there is a key performance need or opportunity, true interdependency and shared accountability. If they are not functioning as real teams, the result is disaster.

Examples of situations where you often find work groups are a functional department in an organization, or clerks in a department store, or waiters in a restaurant. In each one of these groups there can be similar individual objectives, but a lack of any small group

common objective. There is some form of coordination or collaboration, but not usually shared accountability or interdependency. In each of these work group examples, if a significant performance need or opportunity existed, then it would be worthwhile to explore the choice to become a real team with a common group objective, shared accountability, true interdependency and other real team attributes.

The decision whether to become a real team or a work group should be made based on the advantages obtained versus the investment required.

(After Marie Kane: *Distinguishing Teams from Work Groups Is Critical*, Retrieved on Sept. 9, 2009, <http://www.leader-values.com/Content/detail.asp?ContentDetailId=76>)

参考译文

工作小组和真正团队的区别

区分团队和工作小组十分重要，因为一个群体的运作水平影响到：

- (1) 群体成员对公司所作贡献的能力；
- (2) 群体成员的个人发展以及满意度；
- (3) 群体拓展的资源回报（时间、个人才干、金钱等）；
- (4) 群体运作、发展以及维持的要求。

工作小组和真正团队的区别

区分工作小组和真正团队的主要因素在于观察是否存在以下几点：

- (1) 是否有不断增加的绩效要求或机会；
- (2) 成员之间是否真正相互依赖；
- (3) 是否有共同分担的责任。

决定某项工作是由团队还是工作小组来完成，一个最好的判断标准是：这项工作是否有不断增强的绩效要求或机会。换句话说，就是是否要求企业绩效发生重大变化或有否这样的机会。对于每项工作，重要的是选择合适的小组或者团队来完成。从本质上说，小组和团队并无优劣之分。如果一项工作有绩效要求或有这样的机会，启用团队可能是更好的选择。如果没有的话，可以首选工作小组。团队具有更强的绩效潜力，但和工作小组相比，团队需要不断的改进和维护。归根到底，这关系到投资的收益问题。还要牢记的是，收益并不只是以金钱来衡量的，还要以员工工作生涯的质量以及其他无形因素来衡量，这些无形因素虽然不能始终带来即时影响，但却是影响公司盈亏的决定因素。需要启用真正团队的工

作场合有：体育团队或急诊室里的创伤治疗小组。这两种场合，有着重要的绩效要求或机会，成员之间真正相互依赖，共同分担责任。如果成员不能发挥真正的团队功能，那结果将是灾难性的。

通常启用工作小组的场合有：公司里的职能部门或百货公司的店员、餐馆的服务员。在这些群组中，成员可能怀有各种相似的个人目标，但缺乏一个小型团体的共有目标。工作小组虽然也有某种形式的协调和合作，但一般都缺乏共有的责任感和相互依赖感。在团队和工作小组这两个例子中，如果有重要的绩效要求或机会，那就值得探讨、选择组建具有共同团体目标、共担责任、真正相互依赖以及其他特征的真正团队。决定是组建真正的团队还是工作小组，应该基于对所获利益和所需投入的衡量。

1.1.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) What do you think is the role of a team leader?
你认为团队负责人的职责是什么？
- (2) What are the effective ways to boost team morale?
提升团队士气有什么有效方式？
- (3) What is essential in successful team building?
成功的团队建设什么最主要？
- (4) Is it a good idea to hire a team building provider? (Why? /Why not?)
雇佣团队建设顾问是个好主意吗？(为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) A team leader is a person who leads a group of individuals to achieve set objectives or goals. Providing instruction, direction and coordinating the team work are the major responsibilities of a team leader. A team leader also performs many of the same tasks as the rest of the team members.

(2) One way is to organize team-related events so that employees feel more connected to one another and this will enhance a greater sense of responsibility for the success of the team. Another way is to give incentives to those who have performed well, or to address the suggestions given by team members.

(3) I think the secret of successful team building is setting up mutual trust. When members share a trusting relationship, they will better communicate with each other. This

helps to bring out the potentials, experience and creativity of the individual and create good work environment.

(4) Yes. If we get professional advice from a team building provider, we can improve the way team members communicate, upgrade their ability to solve problems and increase work efficiency in general.

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

Organizing a team building event

- planning the schedule in advance
- costs of the event
-

组织团队建设活动需要考虑哪些要素?

- 预先制订计划
- 活动所需费用
-

Suggested answer

When organizing a team building event, the first thing you need to do is planning the event ahead of time. You should work with your team closely to work out all aspects of the planned event, such as setting clear objectives, deciding on effective team-building activities, choosing venues, predicting things that can go wrong during the event, etc. Full preparation can help you truly build up team spirit and ensure that your team members get something out of the event you organize.

With that being said, we can move on to the next important thing we need to consider, that is costs of the event. We need to work out what we have to purchase to help the event move along, and how much it will cost.

On top of that, we should also decide whether to hire others to help us set the event up properly.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

A Good Team Leader

The company you work for is thinking of selecting a new team leader. You have been asked to make suggestions about the makings of a good team leader.

Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what personal qualities a team leader should possess
- what leadership style a good team leader should choose

称职的团队负责人

你们公司正在考虑选出一个新的团队负责人, 请你们提出建议, 一个称职的团

队负责人必须具备什么品质。讨论并决定：

- 称职的团队负责人必须具备的个人素质
- 称职的团队负责人应该选择什么领导风格

Suggested answer

- A: I think the most important personal quality we expect in a good team leader is integrity—a good leader should be an honest and trustworthy person, he or she should be committed to ethical values.
- B: Yes. I'm quite with you here. Integrity helps to reinforce ethical behaviours among team members and enhance cooperation and build up good working atmosphere.
- A: Competence is another important leadership quality. A good team leader should be experienced and capable of coordinating tasks the team is supposed to achieve. A competent team leader can always command the attention and respect of the team members so that he or she can direct the team efficiently and provide assistance when necessary.
- B: I agree. Decisiveness is also important. A good team leader should have the ability to make decisions quickly based on the information at hand and stick to these decisions. A team leader must constantly tell team members what to do and make decisions about projects. Inability to make right decisions can hamper project progress. And if the leader goes back on decisions, he can lose his integrity and credibility.
- A: You're quite right. A team leader should also be open-minded and easy-going. If workers are afraid to approach their team leader, it can result in communication failure.
- B: Yes. Besides all this, creativity and innovative spirit are also expected in a good team leader.
- A: Yes, of course. A leader leads based on his strengths, not on his titles. And I should say the leadership style a team leader chooses will have direct impact on the workplace.
- B: I think a democratic leadership style is very effective in mobilizing the team toward a common vision. The teammates will be happy to contribute fresh ideas and work together for the shared objectives.
- A: Being a good team leader means that he can never give up on the team. A democratic style enables the leader to communicate more effectively with the team and increase work efficiency.

B: Good leaders are always willing to listen. An overbearing leader can only lead to negative team emotions.

A: Yes. A good leader doesn't act like a bossy person who's in charge of everyone. He himself is a good team player.

Follow-up questions

(1) What are the bad effects of never praising your teammates?

从不赞扬团队成员有什么不良结果?

(2) What are the qualities bad leaders have in common?

不称职的团队负责人有什么共同之处?

(3) Should the length of service be considered in selecting a team leader?
(Why? /Why not?)

选定团队负责人时是否应该考虑工作年限? (为什么?)

(4) Is emotion management skill important for a team leader? (Why? /Why not?)

对团队负责人来说, 情绪管理是否重要? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) As a team leader, you should always be ready to praise your teammates whenever they have done a good job. Not to show your appreciation for their efforts can discourage them and as a result can lower the morale of the team.

(2) Bad leaders usually have a negative attitude towards everything. They are overly critical and always see negative outcomes in just about everything the team members do. They cannot trust people and usually lack communication skills, so they tend to ignore information or concerns raised by his teammates.

(3) Yes. If you choose a person who has worked in the company for a considerable length of time, he certainly has a good knowledge of the organization, and can make better decisions suited to the workplace.

(4) Yes. Being a team leader can be emotionally challenging. Emotional maturity is what a good team leader should possess. He should be able to not only control his own emotions, but gauge the motions of his team, manage their anxieties and effectively influence them in a positive way.

1.2 Internal Communications

内部沟通

1.2.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

Nokia 诺基亚公司 (芬兰移动通信制
造商)

be committed to 致力于……

be engaged in 投身于……, 忙于……

delivery *n.* 传输, 传送

corporate information 公司信息

interaction *n.* 交往, 互相影响

vision *n.* 设想, 远见

openness *n.* 坦诚, 公开

integrity *n.* 诚信, 诚实

paramount *adj.* 极为重要的

-wide (后缀, 与名词一起构成形容
词或副词) 全……范围的

opinion survey 意见调查

put in place 实施, 到位

audience-driven *adj.* 以受众为导向的

communications approach 沟通方式

segmentation *n.* 分割, 切断

customisation *n.* 根据对方需要制作,
量身定做

integrated platform 集成的(信息)平台

cost efficiency 成本效率

digital media 数码媒介

intranet *n.* 企业内部互联网

notice-board *n.* 布告牌

open-minded *adj.* 胸襟开阔的

mettle *n.* 勇气, 精神

initiative *n.* 主动性

sense of corporate citizenship 企业公民

意识

coherent *adj.* 一致的, 连贯的

corporate identity 一贯的企业形象

interpersonal skills 人际交往技能

performance excellence 优异表现

keep track of 与……保持联系

PowerPoint Presentation ppt 演讲

sharpen up 使敏锐, 提高、磨练(才
智、技能等)

compelling *adj.* 令人信服的, 引人注
目的

engaging *adj.* 吸引人的, 动人的, 有
魅力的

dynamic *adj.* 生气勃勃的, 充满激情
与活力的, (工作)效率高的

workshop *n.* 专题会, 讨论会

put across 解释, 表达

respond to 回答, 响应, 作出反应

panic-struck *adj.* 惊慌失措的, 吓得手
足无措的(亦作 panic-stricken)

build up 增加, 树立

self belief 自信

rise to the occasion 应付自如

come to life 变得活跃, 显得逼真

corporate world 商业界

corporate humor 商界幽默, (公司)
工作中的幽默

a sense of humor 幽默感

instrumental *adj.* 有助于……, 起作用的

1.2.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

企业内部沟通

在竞争日益激烈的今天，企业内部沟通具有日益重要的战略意义。企业中人与人之间、部门与部门之间有效的沟通和交流，有利于企业文化氛围的形成；有利于各职能部门之间的协作配合；有利于增进员工间的相互信任，形成统一的价值观和强大的凝聚力；有利于满足员工的心理需要，调动员工参与企业经营活动的积极性和创造性；有利于提高企业的竞争力和经济效益。

沟通无处不在，沟通是双向互动的。企业要搞好内部沟通，首先要通过现代企业文化建设，打破等级制度，树立全员沟通理念；其次要建立、健全有效的沟通渠道，通过双向交流和信息互动反馈，使内部沟通渠道畅通无阻。

企业中内部沟通最常用的沟通渠道一般有书面沟通、口头沟通和网络沟通。在书面沟通中较常用的是报告书、墙报、公司手册、内部刊物等。口头沟通的主要形式有会议讲话、面对面的晤谈、电话洽谈等。信息技术与电脑网络技术的发展，也为组织成员之间的沟通创造了一种新的形式。通过互联网，一台电脑可以将任何时间、任何地点需要沟通的双方联系起来，传递信息速度之快、方法之便是以往任何工具不能比拟的，因而网络已成为企业内部沟通的主要渠道之一。

1.2.3 Background Reading（相关背景阅读）

Internal Communications

Nokia is committed to a strong internal communications culture and practice. Its broad range of communications activities, channels and media strive to help employees manage and use corporate information they receive in their work and organisational relationships and in doing so, be fully engaged in the delivery of the company's strategy and the Nokia Way.

Nokia promotes a culture where good communications practice is integrated into every day interaction with and between employees and where shared vision and goals, shared knowledge, openness, speed and integrity are paramount.

The company measures its performance in internal communications through the company-wide annual employee opinion survey as well as targeted surveys around specific communications activities.

Nokia is putting in place an audience-driven communications approach to meet the diverse needs of its employees for information and communication, with emphasis on segmentation, customisation and choice of access. This work is supported by the development and

use of common and integrated platforms and processes which will encourage cost efficiency in the use of internal and external resources and adoption over time of digital media.

There are three primary channels for communicating with employees. *Nokia People* magazine is published in the four most common languages in Nokia: English, Finnish, Chinese and German. *Nokia News Service* offers daily online news from around the organisation, and the Intranet contains a vast amount of detailed company information.

参考译文

内部沟通

诺基亚公司致力于建立一种强有力的内部沟通文化和实践体系。诺基亚公司通过各种广泛的沟通活动以及丰富的沟通渠道和媒介，尽力帮助员工管理和运用他们的工作中以及在企业交往中获得的公司信息。公司通过这种做法，切实传播公司的运作策略以及“诺基亚之道”。

诺基亚公司倡导这样一种公司文化：将良好的沟通习惯融入公司与员工以及员工与员工之间的日常交往之中。在这一公司文化中，共同的期望和目标、共享的知识、坦诚、高效和诚信高于一切。

诺基亚公司通过在公司上下进行一年一度的员工意见调查，以及针对具体沟通活动的目标调查，衡量公司内部沟通方面的绩效。

诺基亚公司正在实施以受众为导向的沟通方式，以满足员工对信息和交流的不同需要，着重强调沟通职能的切分、量体裁衣式的沟通方式以及沟通途径的选择。这项工作得以展开是通过开发和使用了普通以及集成的信息平台和处理程序，在运用内外资源的过程中激励成本效率，并采用了数码媒介等方式。

诺基亚公司和员工沟通有三种不同的渠道。《诺基亚人》杂志采用四种语言出版：英语、芬兰语、汉语和德语；诺基亚新闻服务网每天提供在线的公司新闻；还有企业内部互联网，提供了大量详细的公司信息。

1.2.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's Questions

- (1) What are the methods of communication to staff in most companies?

大多数公司采用什么方式和员工进行沟通？

- (2) Do you think you are good at communicating with your boss? (Why? /Why not?)

你觉得自己善于和上司沟通吗？（为什么？）

(3) Is it important to let your manager know your ideas about work? (Why?)

让你的上司知道你对工作的看法是否重要？（为什么？）

(4) What are the major benefits of corporate communication training?

企业沟通技巧培训有哪些主要好处？

Suggested answers

(1) The most popular communication methods include: face-to-face communication, E-mails, telephone, notice-boards, etc. Nowadays, the Intranet is a very effective method of communication.

(2) Yes. I think I'm quite good at communicating with people. Whenever I have some new ideas or resentment about my work, I'll talk to my boss face to face. I'm very frank and open-minded, ready to accept different opinions.

(I'm afraid I'm not really very good at communicating with people. You see, I'm not a very out-going person, and I feel so nervous every time I talk to other people, particularly my boss.)

(3) I think it's very important. You see, I often make suggestions to my boss about internal development, and discuss areas I would like to improve on. In this way, I'm contributing to the overall improvement of the company.

(Sharing with your boss your new ideas about work is very important. This is where you can really show your mettle. Most bosses appreciate such initiative and will respect you for that.)

(4) It gives the employees a genuine sense of corporate citizenship, enhances mutual understanding and trust; and it promotes a strong corporate culture and a coherent corporate identity.

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

和员工沟通管理信息需考虑哪些

Communicating management messages to the staff

要点？

- overall purpose
- feedback on performance
-

- 整体目标
- 对工作表现的反馈
-

Suggested answer

First of all, I think it's important to clearly state your overall purpose and expectations. In this way, employees know exactly what they should do to meet work requirements

and to achieve performance excellence.

In addition to this, providing feedback on their performance is also important. On the managerial part, performance reviews help managers to keep track of possible problems in their own work. On the part of the employees, they get encouraged for their hard work and are given chances to correct mistakes made on the job.

Besides, managers should be more open in sharing information with their subordinates. They should let employees know in advance any proposed changes before they actually occur. This will enhance mutual understanding and trust.

Part Three: Collaborative task and discussion

Business PowerPoint Presentation Skills Training

Your company would like to introduce PowerPoint Presentation Training to all staff members.

You have been asked to help co-ordinate the project.

Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what are the main purposes of the training
- what kinds of items should be included in the training

商务 ppt 演讲技巧培训

你们公司意欲为员工举办一个商务 ppt 演讲技巧培训班，以提高员工的商务沟通能力，请你们共同协调这一计划。讨论并决定：

- 商务 ppt 演讲技巧培训的主要目的
- 商务 ppt 演讲技巧培训应包含哪些主要内容

Suggested answer

A: You see, our company is initiating a business PowerPoint Presentation Skills Training plan for all staff members. It certainly is a very good chance to improve our communication skills.

B: Yes. We all need to sharpen up our presentation techniques to communicate better with people.

A: I think we should aim to help our employees to learn to create more compelling, engaging and dynamic PowerPoint presentations.

B: And to explore more convincing and effective ways to structure ppt presentations, and to revise the presentations to suit audiences of varied sizes and purposes.

B: Yes. I think it is also important to help our staff to learn how to adapt materials to

the situation, how to use creative and unusual approaches in ppt presentation, how to be more persuasive and how to share fresh ideas with audiences in a more professional way.

A: Yes, I'm quite with you here. Training of this kind will certainly help staff members to advance their presentations to a new level.

B: I agree with you. But we need to work out the major content, otherwise, our training plan won't be effective.

A: You're quite right! Our workshop should be designed to look at everything from ways to get started, to structuring ideas and focusing on the key messages, practice its delivery and receive constructive feedback in business ppt presentation.

B: Just a minute, I think we should write them down point by point. First of all, I think we'll start with ppt presentation preparation, and in doing so, we need to know our audience so that our presentation is more adapted to them; second, we should concentrate on the issue of how to structure our ppt materials and...

A: Right! Putting across a clear message is very important in delivering an effective business presentation. Presenters should also learn how to focus on the message so that they can get their message across clearly and memorably.

B: Well, er... you see, I think what you call "presenters" are best called "communicators". In doing business ppt presentation, it is important to create an interactive, question friendly atmosphere, and look for the audience reactions and respond to their signals.

A: That's great! Interaction with the audience!

B: Have we covered everything?

A: Oh, there's one more point: raising confidence of the speakers.

B: Right, some people get anxious, terrified, or even totally panic-struck at the thought of giving a presentation.

A: A successful presenter is always confident. We should learn to build up self belief, learn to know that we have hidden resources that will rise to the occasion as required.

B: Yes, with these essential skills, speakers can make their ideas come to life in the presentation.

A: I agree.

Follow-up questions

(1) Do you think it's important for staff members to learn PowerPoint presentation skills? (Why?)

你认为员工学会 ppt 演讲技巧是否很重要? (为什么?)

(2) Do you communicate with your colleagues often and how?

你是否经常和同事沟通? 怎样沟通的?

(3) Is dressing important for the ppt presenter? (Why?)

对于 ppt 演讲者来说, 着装是否重要? (为什么?)

(4) What do you think of humour in business presentation?

你怎么看商务演讲中的幽默?

(5) How important is corporate ppt presentation?

商务 ppt 演讲有何重要性?

Suggested answers

(1) Yes. Presentation skills are important in every profession but are considered of prime importance in the corporate world. Presentation skills are essential drivers of our activity, they ably assist us in putting our ideas across to other people and win understanding from them.

(2) Yes. I often communicate with my colleagues, we share corporate information together. exchange news and views. In most cases, we chat with each other, sometimes we email to each other.

(3) Yes. Dressing should be given utmost importance, as the first impression before the presentation is vital. The presenter should be neatly dressed to leave a good impression on the audience.

(4) Laughter is necessary in work. Corporate humor helps to make your workload light and boosts your energy level. And if you have a sense of humor, it helps to enhance atmosphere at the presentation and the audience will become more friendly and engaging.

(5) A lot of business promotion depends on our day to day interaction with various people. Presentations are an integral part of it. Effective presentations are instrumental in promoting business and earn profits.

1.3 Reducing Production Cost

降低生产成本

1.3.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

result in 导致, 造成

供的标准统称

ISO 9000 一组为质量管理体系框架提

cut corners 抄近路, 走捷径, 偷工减料

greener pastures 更绿的牧场（比喻更好的谋生去处，更好的工作、职位）
deadwood *n.* 枯枝，朽木；无用的人
nuisance *n.* 讨厌的人或事，麻烦事
ex-customer *n.* 过去的顾客，以前的顾客
in the short run 在短期内
go through the roof 大大增加，上涨到出乎意料的程度
TQM (Total Quality Management) 全面质量管理
under the umbrella of 在……的保护下
cost accountant 成本会计师
cost control 成本控制
prognosis *n.* 预告，预言
customer service 客户服务中心，客户服务
customer satisfaction 客户满意度
cost effective （有）成本效益的
competitive edge 竞争优势，竞争力
cost-efficient *adj.* 成本效益高的
cost management 成本管理
cut down 削减，减少
raw material 原料
to a large extent 在很大程度上
cost-conscious *adj.* 注重节约成本的
short-listed 经过筛选的，入选初试名单的

lavish *adj.* 浪费的，挥霍的
narrow down 限制，限定
wastage *n.* 浪费，损耗，损失
shift work 倒班制，轮班工作（一般指三班倒，即 day shift 白班，evening shift 晚班，以及 night shift 夜班）
permanent schedule 固定班（亦称 fixed schedule）
rotating schedule 轮班制
out of step with 与……步调不一致
adjust to 对……适应
fight off 竭力避免
body rhythm 生理节奏
stressful *adj.* （心理、生理或情绪上的）紧张，压力
consultancy service 咨询服务
psychological consultancy 心理咨询
night shift blues 夜班忧郁症
all this （词组）所有这一切
health counselling facilities 健康咨询设施
health facilities 健身设备
round the clock 24 小时
translate to 转化为
hazard *n.* 危害，公害
adequate lighting 充分的照明，足够的照明
proper heat 适当的室温

1.3.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

生产成本管理

现代企业面对瞬息万变的市场环境，既要求得生存，更要求得长期的成长和发展，而低成本成为衡量企业是否具有竞争优势的重要标准之一。加强成本管理，更

有效地降低成本，在企业经营战略中已处于极其重要的核心地位，它从根本上决定着企业竞争力的强弱。

企业的生产成本包括由人工费用、材料费用等构成的制造成本和由管理费用、财务费用、销售费用构成的期间费用。生产成本的高低直接影响到产品的价格定位和市场竞争力。也就是说，它与企业的盈利水平构成因果关系，直接决定着企业的生死存亡。因此，各企业都把降低生产成本、提高生产效率放在首位，综合运用各种管理方法和手段来提高企业的生产和竞争能力。

企业成本管理的一个主要方法是全面质量管理（Total Quality Management, TQM）。它是以组织全员参与为基础的质量管理形式，以质量为中心，以全员参与为基础，目的在于通过让顾客满意和本企业所有成员及社会受益而达到长期成功的管理途径。同时，“全面”还相对于制造过程而言，产品质量产生、形成和实现的过程，包括市场研究、研制、设计、制定标准、制定工艺、采购、配备设备、加工制造、工序控制、检验、销售、售后服务等多个环节。通过对各个环节实行控制，才能提高成本效益。

1.3.3 Background Reading（相关背景阅读）

Reducing Business Costs

Cost reduction is an important factor in improving the state of a business. It can obviously result in higher profits and a stronger enterprise. Most business leaders and managers would like to reduce costs, but many find it difficult to do the right things.

There are several methods business leaders or managers use to reduce costs that can be damaging to the health of the organisation. These include downsizing, reducing customer service, and cutting corners in production methods.

Downsizing

Some company leaders feel they can reduce costs by simply downsizing or reducing the number of workers or middle managers.

If this is done after applying ISO 9000 and defining the exact role of everyone, it may be a necessary and effective method. Unfortunately, most companies that downsize do so without really knowing the impact on the company's operations.

One of the biggest effects of downsizing to reduce costs is that the good employees quickly leave the company for greener pastures. Thus the company is left with the dead-wood employees, who are supposed to do twice the work as before.

Reducing Customer Service

Customer service can be a nuisance and is often expensive. Sometimes companies will

reduce or eliminate the service they give to the customers. Unfortunately, a neglected customer is an ex-customer.

Cutting Corners

A quick way to cut costs is by cutting corners in production or service methods. Some company leaders feel that by using cheaper materials and labor, and by eliminating part and steps, they can cut costs and save money.

It is true that costs may be cut in the short run, but often the product or service is of such a low quality that repair and rework costs go through the roof. Also customers may become unhappy with the low quality and move on to another supplier.

Effective ways to reduce costs include training your workers, getting quality goods from suppliers, and using Total Quality Management (TQM) tools. Because to reduce costs means to reduce waste. That is wasted materials, wasted effort, and wasted time.

Train Workers

In these days of changing technologies and methods, it is necessary to train your workers to keep them up to date.

Get Quality from Suppliers

Low quality goods from suppliers is a major source of waste. You should not only try to get quality suppliers but also work with your suppliers to help them improve their operations and quality of output.

TQM Tools

There are a number of improvement methods that can be placed under the umbrella of Total Quality Management (TQM).

In conclusion, crude methods to reduce costs—such as downsizing—are not effective and can actually harm a business. Helping your suppliers, training your workers, and using TQM-type improvement tools can help to eliminate waste and improve the profits of your business.

参考译文

降低经营成本

降低成本是改进企业状况的一个重要因素。它可以明显地提高利润，壮大企业。大多数企业主管和经理都想降低成本，但大多感到难以找到正确的途径。

企业主管和经理采用的削减成本的有些方法对企业的健康发展是有害的。这些方法包括缩小企业规模、减少客户服务，以及在生产中偷工减料。

缩小企业规模

有些公司领导认为，可以通过缩小企业规模或者精简员工或中层管理人员来减少成本。

如果是在实施 ISO 9000 质量管理体系，并已对每个成员的角色做出了细致的规定之后，这有可能不失为必要并且有效的一种方法。但遗憾的是大多数削减规模的公司采用了裁员这种方法，却并不真正知道这种方法对公司运作所产生的影响。

以裁员的方法来削减成本，一个最大的副作用就是不少好员工很快就会离开公司另谋高就。公司就只剩下了一些庸员，而这些人要承担两倍于以前的工作量。

减少客户服务

客户服务可能是件麻烦事并且耗资巨大。有时公司会减少甚至取消为客户们提供的服务。但遗憾的是，一个被冷落的客户就不再是你的客户了。

偷工减料

削减成本的一个捷径是在生产或服务过程中偷工减料。有些企业领导认为，他们可以利用更为廉价的原材料和劳动力，减去一些步骤，以此减少成本，节省费用。

诚然，这样做在短期内可以削减成本，但是往往会使产品和服务的质量低下，结果是补救、返工的成本奇高无比，而且造成客户对产品质量不满并另找供应商。

降低成本的有效方法包括对员工进行培训、从供货商处购买优质的产品，以及启用全面质量管理（TQM）工具。因为降低成本意味着减少浪费，即减少对原材料、人工和时间的浪费。

培训员工

在技术和生产手段日新月异的今天，有必要对员工进行培训，使他们赶上新的发展。

从供货商处购买优质的产品

购买低质量的产品是最大的浪费源。你不仅需要寻找能提供高质量产品的供货商，而且还需要帮助他们改进经营和产品质量。

全面质量管理工具

在全面质量管理工具体系内有许多改善经营的方法。

总之，粗劣的降低成本的方法，例如缩小企业的规模，不仅无效，而且还会对企业造成损害。为你的供货商提供帮助，对员工进行培训，并启用全面质量管理型改进工具，这些将有助于减少浪费，提高企业的盈利能力。

1.3.4 Sample Test（□试样例）

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's Questions

- (1) Is it important to consult a cost accountant when starting a new project?
(Why? /Why not?)
启动新项目时，向成本会计师咨询是否重要？（为什么？）
- (2) In what ways is customer service related to cost reduction?
客户服务在哪些方面与降低成本有关？
- (3) Do you think people can be trained to work more efficiently? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为人们通过培训可以提高工作效率吗？（为什么？）
- (4) What changes in cost management do you expect will happen in the future?
你认为将来在成本管理方面会有哪些变化？

Suggested answers

(1) Yes. It's paramount in cost control. The cost accountant can prepare budgets and give a prognosis for the project. His advice is essential in deciding whether to undertake or abandon the planned project.

(2) Customer service can enhance customer satisfaction and loyalty. Good customer relationship helps to improve your company image and boost sales. As a result, largescale production will be cost effective for your company.

(3) Yes. I think staff training is extremely important nowadays. You see, technologies keep changing and if employees get regular training, they would be able to work more efficiently. It's the competence of the workforce that sharpens the competitive edge of the company.

(4) I expect it will head towards more cost-efficient methods, involving more parties in the process of production; not only corporate management and staff, but also suppliers, retailers and even customers.

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

要控制公司接待成本需考虑哪些

Aiming to control cost in corporate

要点？

hospitality

- event planning
- food costs
-

- 活动计划
- 食品成本
-

Suggested answer

Cost control is the top priority in corporate hospitality. Cost-conscious companies always seek to slash hospitality costs by budgeting carefully. If you plan ahead of the event, you will have enough time to work on such details as the exact number of people to be entertained, the right supplier, etc. In this way, you can save lots of money. So good planning is the key to every successful event.

Secondly, to keep the cost at the minimum, you have to work out the food costs carefully. Recipes need to be short-listed and menus should be made in advance for preparing the costing report and finalising price. Avoid a lavish menu by taking expensive food off the menu and narrow down to something basic and healthy.

Also, another important aspect is reducing wastage. You need to control food portions and portion sizes to eliminate waste.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Introducing Shift Work

Your company would like to introduce shift work operation to optimize the production process. You have been asked to help co-ordinate the project. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- how to arrange the work schedule
- how to match staff to this new work requirement

实行倒班作业制

你们公司正在考虑实行倒班作业制以优化生产过程。请你们协助策划这一计划。讨论并决定：

- 怎样安排工作时间表
- 怎样使工人适应这一新的工作要求

Suggested answers

A: When introducing shift work, the most important thing is to work out good work schedules. I think we can divide our twenty-four hour operation into three shifts: day shift, evening shift and night shift. And we'll have the permanent schedule. It's tough to work at night, but once you get used to it, it's easier to fight off the night-time fatigue.

B: Well, I partly agree with you. I mean "the three shifts" is a good idea, but I think it would be better if we adopt the rotating schedule. You see, shift-work

disrupts the body rhythm and is very stressful. Besides, it affects home life, the night shift worker is out of step with his family.

A: That's the problem. Night shifts really affect our health conditions. So you're right, the rotating schedule has more advantages over the fixed schedule.

B: All right. So we'll adopt the rotating schedule, three shifts and the day shift is from 8:00a. m. to 5:00p. m. with a lunch-break. And evening shift, 5:00p. m. to 1:00a. m. , including coffee breaks, and then. . .

A: And night shift from 1:00a. m. to 8:00a. m. , also with a coffee break.

B: Right. We should also provide our shift workers with training programmes to help them better adjust to this new work requirement. We should inform them of the harmful effects of night shifts and give them tips on how to prevent and fight off these hazards.

A: Yes. We can arrange health specialists to give them training courses and provide online consultancy service for the convenience of our shift workers. And I think we should also provide psychological consultancy just in case they get too stressed. We need to help them to cope with night shift blues.

B: Good. It's also important to provide some nutritious food during the evening and night shifts.

A: That's a good idea. On top of all this, we can provide workers with health facilities to encourage them to do more physical exercises.

B: That's just what I want to say.

Follow-up questions

(1) What benefits will your company gain from shift work operation?

你公司可从倒班制中获得什么好处？

(2) How important is it to inform workers of the hazards of night shift?

把夜班的害处告知工人有何重要性？

(3) Do you think companies should provide health counselling facilities? (Why? / Why not?)

你认为公司应该提供健康咨询便利吗？（为什么？）

(4) Should work environment be taken into consideration when designing shift work? (Why? / Why not?)

设计倒班制时是否应该考虑工作环境？（为什么？）

(5) Is regular physical exercise important for shift workers? (Why? / Why not?)

经常运动对倒班工人是否很重要？（为什么？）

Suggested answers

(1) If we keep our equipment operating round the clock, we'll be able to use our productive equipment to its fullest potential, that would help to optimize the production process. You see, improved productivity translates directly to higher profits.

(2) It's certainly of great importance. Employees' well-being and security should be the first priority of the management. When shift workers are fully aware of the hazards, they will take better care of themselves.

(3) In my opinion, it's a must in this highly competitive age. Employees often become stressful and develop health problems. Management should provide health counselling facilities to help improve the physical and mental health of the staff and boost their morale.

(No. A company cannot possibly provide everything to its employees. As health counselling facilities are available anywhere, employees can readily go to them after work. But it's good for companies to provide information about these facilities.)

(4) Poor working conditions add to the strain of shift work. Adequate lighting, clean air, proper heat, air-conditioning and reduced noise will help to reduce the shiftworker's burden.

(5) Physical exercises are extremely important for night shift workers. Jogging, walking, cycling or swimming will help them to relax and to minimize stress. You see, shift work disrupts the body rhythm and is very harmful to your health.

1.4 Reducing Overheads

减少管理费用

1.4.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

venture *n.* 冒险, 投机, 风险

add up 合计, 累计

take out a loan 获得贷款

deplete *v.* 耗尽, 用光

life savings 毕生的积蓄

severance *n.* 契约中止

figure out 计算出, 合计为

certification *n.* 证明, 保证

perk *n.* 额外津贴 (亦作 *perquisite*)

barter *n. & v.* 物品交换, 实物交易

function 重大聚会, 官方典礼或正式社交场合

property manager 物业管理经理人

literally *adv.* 真正, 完全, 简直

convert to 转变为, 变换成

fluorescent lighting 荧光照明

high-efficiency 高效的

cut down on 减少

call on 动用, 指派
rate *n.* 价格, 费用
hotel bill 旅馆住宿费用
public transportation fares 公交费用
expenses claims system 报销制度
abuse *n.* 滥用, 妄用
malpractice *n.* 失职行为, 玩忽职守
discount air ticket 打折机票
electric rates 电费
apportion *vt.* 分摊, 分配
over-expenditure 超支
office supplies 办公用品
stationery *n.* 文具
paper clip 回形针, 曲别针
name-brand *n.* 知名品牌
generic brand 普通品牌

group purchasing 团购
bulk price 批发价
mail-order *n.* 邮购
rough draft 草稿
put in a word 说一句话, 插一句话
disposable *n.* 一次性用品
printer cartridge 打印机墨盒
rechargeable battery 可充电电池
comply with 遵守
profitability *n.* 盈利能力, 获利能力
in the long run 从长远来看
diversify *vi. & vt.* 使多样化, 做多样性的投资
might as well do sth. 不妨做……
abide by 遵守
paperless office 无纸化办公

1.4.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

企业的费用

企业的费用主要包括营业费用、管理费用和财务费用。其中管理费用（Overheads）是指经营企业的日常开支成本，它主要包括管理人员的工资、福利费、差旅费、宣传广告费、业务招待费、订报费、邮费、水电费、租金、长期待摊费用、坏账准备和风险准备，等等。由于管理费用不随产量的增加而改变，因此也被称为固定成本中的间接成本。

“费用”与“利润”是完全对立的，费用越大，利润就越少。但由于管理费用的弹性较大，企业通常就会通过各种途径来削减管理费用，如：通过对人力资源的有效管理、精简人员，通过机构整合压缩办公费用的开支，进行严格的成本预算和监管，控制企业的招待费、广告费、差旅费的支出，节约能源、降低企业运作成本等措施。这样，企业通过对内部成本和费用的控制，并做好预算，加强管理力度，减少不必要的支出，就能够降低管理成本、提高利润，增加企业的价值。

1.4.3 Background Reading (相关背景阅读)

How to cut costs by reducing overhead

Starting up a business is an expensive venture. Many people don't realize the high costs that often go into starting up a new business. Expenses like advertising, equipment and machinery, office space, and licensing and fees to make your business legal all add up, sometimes turning out to be more money than expected.

However, these overhead costs don't necessarily mean you have to take out a loan or deplete your life savings in order to start your business. The following are some ways you can cut costs by reducing your overhead:

Hire the right number of people

Your largest expenses will typically be your employees. If you hire too many people, you will have to go through expenses such as severance. Look at your busiest times and days and figure out the number of employees you will need by averaging the two. Start with the minimum amount needed without compromising on service or making your employees work longer or harder than you need to.

If you have a seasonal business, or experience more business during a certain day of the week or time of the year, consider hiring part-time or seasonal employees.

Reduce training costs

Training employees can be expensive. Offer employees incentives to cover the costs of their own training and certification by offering other perks to them, such as paid time off or additional vacation time. You could also offer to pay part of training instead of all.

Barter services

You may also be able to cut your overhead costs by bartering your services with others. For example, if you are opening a bakery and need printing services for your marketing materials, you might be able to work out an arrangement with them by offering to cater their next employee function. Many companies are willing to barter their services in exchange for other work.

Reevaluate your facilities

If you are leasing your building, you may be able to cut overhead costs by talking with your landlord or property manager. Sometimes, you can lower your monthly rent by extending your lease. Don't get a space that is more than you need, or you will literally be paying for unused space.

You may also want to join with other small, non-competing businesses to share expenses such as receptionist and office costs. This can greatly reduce your overhead costs and is an excellent option for businesses just starting out.

As far as utilities go, you can cut overhead by doing such things as converting to fluorescent lighting and using high-efficiency heating and cooling equipment that can cut down on your monthly costs.

Rent equipment

Most businesses cannot afford to buy all of their own equipment in the beginning, especially if they have a highly technical business. By renting instead of buying your equipment, especially computers or specialty equipment, you can greatly cut down on your overhead costs.

Call on friends

If you have friends in certain areas, don't hesitate to call on them and see if they can help you. For example, if you have a friend or family member who sells insurance, you may be able to get a better rate. Consider who you know and what they do when thinking of cutting overhead costs.

参考译文

如何通过减少管理费用削减开支

创建企业是一项费用浩大的风险事业，很多人意识不到创办新企业所需的巨额开支。诸如广告、设备、机器、办公场地、许可证以及使企业合法运作所需的其他费用累积起来，可能会比你想象的还要多。

然而，这些管理费用并不一定意味着你需要贷款或者倾一生之积蓄来创建企业，以下提供一些如何通过减少管理费用削减开支的方法。

合适的雇员数量

最大的开支是雇员费用，如果雇佣的人数太多，公司得被迫支付解雇费。根据公司业务最忙的时间和日子，计算出两者的平均数。在不损害服务质量、不延长员工工作时间或工作强度的前提下，从最低需要开始，算出合适的雇佣人数。

如果公司业务具有季节性，或者在一周的某一天、一年的某个时间内业务量增大，可以考虑雇佣业余或者季节性员工。

减少培训费用

培训员工花费昂贵。向员工提供激励，让他们自己承担培训和证书获得费用，采用提供额外补贴的方法，如带薪休假或者额外休假日等。你也可以承担部分培训费用，而非全部费用。

交换服务

你可以通过和他们交换服务的方式减少管理费用。如果你开的是面包店，需要印刷销售材料，你可以通过向对方提供员工聚会所需的食品，安排和印刷店交换服务。许多公司愿意交换以得到所需服务。

重估设备

如果你租用场地，你可以和出租人或物业经理人谈判以削减费用。有时，你可以通过延长租期获得更低的月租费。不要租用不需要的多余场地，否则你等于就是在为无用的场地支付租金。

你可能考虑和其他小型的、非竞争对手联合起来，共同分担诸如接待员、办公等费用。这可以大大削减你的管理成本，对于刚刚起步的企业来说，这是个极好的选择。

至于公用设施，你可以通过以下办法来减少开支：照明换成日光灯，采用高效能供暖系统和空调设备，这样就可以减少每月的费用。

租用设备

大多数企业在起步时无力购买所有设备，特别是技术性很强的业务。通过租用而不是购置设备，特别是电脑或专用设备，可以大大削减管理成本。

动用朋友

如果在某些行业有你的朋友，可以毫不犹豫地动用朋友，看他们能否帮助你。比如，如果你有朋友或者家人销售保险，你就可以获得更好的价格。考虑削减费用时，想想你认识谁，他们从事什么行业。

1.4.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's Questions

- (1) What expenses do people typically incur on a business trip?
商务差旅中有哪些主要费用?
- (2) How should companies control business travel expenses?
公司应该怎样控制其商务差旅费用?
- (3) Do you think it's necessary to have control over the usage of electricity?

(Why? /Why not?)

你是否认为控制电力使用很重要？（为什么？）

(4) Is it important to involve employees in overheads reduction project? (Why?)

让员工参与办公费用削减计划是否重要？（为什么？）

Suggested answers

(1) Expenses on a business trip include hotel bills, traveling expenses, public transportation fares, fax or telephone charges and client entertainment expenses, etc.

(2) Companies should develop a sound expenses claims system to prevent any system abuse and possible malpractice. Companies should also encourage their business travellers to get discount air tickets.

(3) Yes. Electricity costs are a very important component of overheads, if a company can keep electric rates low, it will certainly be very helpful in overheads reduction.

(4) Yes. Overheads are the indirect cost of business, they are closely related to the welfare of all staff members, so concerted efforts are needed from both managers and staff to implement the overheads reduction project.

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

要削减管理费用需要考虑哪些要点？

Aiming to slash business overheads

- budget and management
- long-term effects
-

- 预算和管理
- 长期效果
-

Suggested answer

First of all, business overhead expenditure needs to be budgeted and apportioned as fairly as possible to different departments of the business. Once we have set a clear budget plan, we'll be able to manage the overheads costs by limiting budget spending and improving overhead productivity. And in case an over-expenditure occurs, we'll be able to track the cause and check it in time.

Meanwhile, long-term effects should also be considered. In reducing overheads costs, we should not aim to seek instant success, we should put our overheads reduction plan in a greater perspective and evaluate their overall effects. Reduction measures should enable the company to tap its potential productivity and ensure its future development.

In addition, to that, we also need to involve our staff members into the overheads re-

duction project, and try to see if they have anything to contribute to it.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Introducing New Ways to Save on Office Supplies

The company you work for has decided to introduce new ways to save on office supplies, as a part of the overheads reduction plan. You have been asked to make suggestions about it. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what are the ways to save office expenses
- how to motivate the staff

实行节省办公用品的新方法

作为削减管理费用计划的一部分,你们公司正在考虑实行节省办公用品的新方法。请你们协助策划这一计划。讨论并决定:

- 节省办公开支有哪些方法
- 怎样激发员工的热情

Suggested answer

- A: To keep office expenses down, we can start from office stationery. Items like pens, paper, paper clips, and pencils do not cost a lot individually, but we use them in large quantities, so there is potential for huge savings.
- B: I'm with you here. You see, there is a great difference in price between the name brand and generic brand stationery, so if we look for cheaper sources, we'll end up saving hundreds of pounds a year.
- A: Yes, cheaper sources are important, we can get much cheaper prices on office supplies through group purchasing. If we pool our orders with other businesses, we can buy in larger quantity and receive lower bulk prices.
- B: Indeed. We can also use mail-order. Mail-order office supply companies are convenient because they deliver to your door, and it saves both gas and time.
- A: We should also encourage staff to recycle used paper, and ask our staff to edit on the screen as much as possible, print one final rough draft to proofread on paper. That's a very effective way to reduce paper consumption.
- B: And buying used office furniture is also an important way of cutting overheads. But to motivate our staff members, there should be measures to monitor their performance regularly. We can...
- A: I'd like to put in a word here, never use disposables in the office, use recycled

printer cartridges and rechargeable batteries.

B: Yes, that's especially important. We should involve all office staff into our cost saving plan. For example, we should ask staff members to turn off the air-conditioner half an hour before they leave the office, so as to cut some electricity bills.

A: You're right. To make sure that our staff voluntarily comply with the overheads expenditure reduction rules, we can include that in our staff appraisals, I mean whether staff members are supportive in our overheads reduction project.

B: I agree. And we can also award those who are most supportive in our project.

A: That's good.

Follow-up questions

- (1) How important is it for companies to keep overheads down?
公司削减管理开支有何重要意义?
- (2) Is it a good idea to cut investment to reduce overheads? (Why? /Why not?)
用减少投资的办法来削减管理费用好吗? (为什么?)
- (3) Might there be some measures that would not be effective? (Why?)
有些措施是否可能无效? (为什么?)
- (4) What do you think the manager should do in overheads cutting project?
在削减管理开支计划中, 经理应该做些什么?
- (5) What new ideas do you have to keep overheads costs down in a company?
关于削减公司的管理费用, 你有什么新的想法?

Suggested answers

(1) Keeping costs under control and overheads down is a priority for all organisations, because overheads costs are directly related to the company's profitability and welfare of the staff members.

(2) No. Cutting investment to reduce costs is a short-term measure. In the long run, it is unfavourable to company development, as limited scale and productivity weakens a company's competitive edge.

(Well, it all depends. If your business diversifies too much, you might as well cut some of your investment and just focus on some areas. In that way, you will be able to reduce overheads.)

(3) Yes. If you set a very low limit on telephone bills, employees might fail to maintain regular contact with their clients or customers for fear of over-expenses.

(4) I think the manager is responsible for budgeting overheads and carefully tracking the costs, minimizing expenditure at all time. He should also see to it that staff members abide by the rules as required.

(5) Companies can make use of the Internet, conducting routine office work through digital media. We can convert every single paper process into a digital one, the so-called "paperless office". It lowers overheads very effectively.

1.5 How to Deal with a Heavy Workload

如何应对繁重的工作

1.5.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

perks *n.* 额外津贴, 补贴 (为 perquisites 的缩略形式)

nicety *n.* 精美之物

high blood pressure 高血压

ulcer *n.* 溃疡

health care benefits 医保福利

Raleigh 罗利市 (北卡罗莱纳州首府)

North Carolina 北卡罗莱纳州

SAS Institute (美国) 赛仕软件研究所

campus *n.* 场地, 校园

coffee break 工间休息

soda *n.* 汽水, 冰淇淋苏打

M&Ms 美国玛氏 (Mars) 公司出品的巧克力豆

pastry *n.* 糕点

eldercare program 老年保健计划

locate nursing care facilities 查找老年护理设施, 老年护理机构

aging parents 年事越来越高的双亲

Cigna Insurance Company 美国信诺保险公司

exercise physiologist 运动生理学家

wellness *n.* 健康, 处于好的身体与精神状况之中 (尤指通过适当的饮食、锻炼及良好的习惯而达到的健康状况)

turnover rate 员工流动率

norm *n.* 标准, 规范

low spirits 情绪低落

paperwork *n.* 文书工作

meet deadline 赶期限

be susceptible to 易感染……疾病, 易受……影响

tactical *adj.* 战术上的, 善于筹划的

stamina *n.* 耐力, 毅力, 持久力

dexterity *n.* 灵巧, 机敏

athletic ability 运动才能

locate a contract 得到一份合同

work through lunch 不吃午饭继续工作

downshift *vt.* (汽车等) 调低速挡, 放慢速度

have easy access to 可方便地使用……

burnout *n.* 耗尽体力

benefits system 福利制度

nutritious refreshment 富含营养的食物
和饮料

childcare vouchers 托儿券

retail voucher 购物券

annual leave 年假

take up a hobby 培养一种业余爱好

get off the treadmill 摆脱单调乏味的工作

Joy Gang 搞笑人员（专门提供以讲笑话或滑稽表演等方式让工作人员放松

的服务）

flexible working 弹性工作制

flexitime *n.* 弹性工作（上班）时间，亦作 flextime

homeworking 在家中上班 [尤指利用家中电脑终端与中心办公室通信，或在离家不远的卫星办公室（satellite office）上班]，亦作 flexplace、flex place 或 flex-place

pay-back *n.* 回报，收益

1.5.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

减轻工作压力

现代生活节奏不断加快，企业运作竞争日益激烈，从业人员终日忙碌，疲于奔波，面临着种种压力：工作繁重、上班时间延长、岗位竞争激烈、工作安全感下降等。过度、持续的压力会对员工的身心健康造成伤害，也不利于企业的经营和发展：如果员工精神压力过大、身心疲惫，就可能会患上各种疾病，这不仅会影响员工队伍的稳定性，导致员工流失频繁，损害员工的创造力，直接削弱企业的竞争能力，而且还会增加公司的医疗福利开支。根据美国一些研究者的调查，每年因员工心理压抑给美国公司造成的经济损失高达 3 050 亿美元，超过财富 500 强大公司税后利润的 5 倍。

重视员工压力的管理，已成为企业人力资源管理的一个重要方面。而压力管理能预防压力对员工造成毁灭性的损害，有效维护、保持企业的“第一资源”——人力资源。员工压力管理有利于减轻员工过重的心理压力，保持适度的、最佳的压力，从而使员工提高工作效率，进而提高整个组织的绩效，增加利润。同时，企业关注员工的压力问题，能够充分体现以人为本的理念，有利于构建良好的企业文化，增强员工对企业的忠诚度。

因此，企业应本着以人为本的原则，关注员工的身心健康。企业往往通过以下几个主要方面来改善环境、减轻员工的工作压力：

健全组织制度，加强过程管理。有的企业在规章制度中明确规定了企业员工的申诉制度，及时解决员工因工作压力造成的紧张情绪。以完善的培训计划、薪酬标准和保障制度增强员工的安全感和较为稳定的就业心理，减轻其压力。有的还通过弹性工作时间、改善福利制度等来改进工作环境，提高工作效率，激发员工的工作

热情和创新能力。

从企业文化氛围上鼓励并帮助员工提高心理保健能力,学会缓解压力、自我放松。通过加强企业文化建设,为员工营造轻松、和谐的工作氛围,并为员工提供专业的心理咨询和各种培训课程、讲座等来指导员工认识压力可能导致的严重后果、压力的早期预警信号、压力的自我调适方法等,帮助员工释放压力,增强心理调节能力。

改善企业的工作环境和条件——企业通过为员工提供休息室、健身房、娱乐设施、播放音乐等手段来减轻或消除工作条件恶劣给员工带来的压力。有的企业甚至还组织一些幽默搞笑活动,让员工在笑声中得到放松。

1.5.3 Background Reading (相关背景阅读)

Perks and Fitness: No Longer a Nicety but a Necessity

Managers know that stress is a barrier to motivating the workforce. They also recognize that stress can result in stress-related illnesses, such as high blood pressure, ulcers, and fatigue. These illnesses translate into higher benefits costs for the company as employees more frequently use health care benefits.

A number of companies use nontraditional benefits and perks to help employees cope with stress. At each of its 20 buildings at its 200-acre campus in Raleigh, North Carolina, SAS Institute provides coffee break rooms stocked with free soda, fresh fruit, M&Ms and pastries. SAS employs a full-time ergonomics specialist to select office furniture that will reduce physical stress and strain. SAS provides a free health clinic as well as an eldercare program that helps employees locate nursing care facilities for aging parents.

Many companies provide benefits that help employees cope with the stresses and demands of balancing work and nonwork. Cigna Insurance Company offers employees the option of placing take-out meal orders with the company chef. Employees who don't have the energy to prepare meals after a long or difficult workday can take home a prepared meal. The company also offers an exercise physiologist to help employees suffering from stress.

Companies are also offering wellness and exercise programs to help employees alleviate stress and enhance their health at the same time. Coca-Cola found that employees who participated in wellness and exercise programs used fewer sick days and tended to be more productive on their jobs.

Are companies providing these services to look good to the community or because they are financially successful? Not really. It is shrewd business operations. For example, it is estimated

that SAS turnover rate is 4 percent compared to the industry norm of more than 20 percent per year. While the free health clinic costs \$ 1 million to operate, it is \$ 500,000 less than the costs the company would realize if employees were treated elsewhere.

参考译文

增加津贴，促进健康：并非锦上添花，而是必不可少

管理者们知道，压力不利于激励员工的士气。他们也意识到，压力会导致相关疾病，如高血压、溃疡病和疲劳症。这些疾病转而成为公司更高的福利费用支出，因为员工会更加频繁地使用医疗服务。

一些公司采用与以往不同的福利措施和额外补贴来帮助员工解决工作压力。赛仕软件研究所位于北卡罗来纳州首府罗利市，它占地 200 英亩，有 20 栋楼。公司在每一栋楼里都设有咖啡屋，免费提供汽水、新鲜水果、巧克力和点心。赛仕软件研究所还聘请了一位全职生物工程学专家，帮助公司挑选能够减轻对身体造成压力和损伤的办公家具。该公司还提供免费医务室和养老计划，帮助员工为年迈的双亲安排敬老服务。

许多公司则提供一些福利计划以帮助员工克服压力并兼顾工作内外。信诺保险公司为员工提供了公司家庭订餐服务，劳累了一天已经没有精力再准备晚餐的员工下班时，可以带着公司大厨烹制好的晚饭回家。公司还有运动生理学家专门为深受压力困扰的员工提供帮助。

有些公司还提供康复和健身计划来帮助员工减缓压力、增进健康。可口可乐公司发现参加康复和健身计划的员工请病休假的时间减少了，而且工作效率得到了很大提高。

公司提供这些服务是为了向社会作秀，还是因为它们财大气粗呢？都不是。这些都是精明的公司运作策略。例如，据估计，赛仕软件研究所的员工流失率为每年 4%，而同行业的员工流失率一般高达每年 20%。虽然免费医务室的运营需要 100 万美元，但公司的总支出要比员工到其他医院就诊减少了 50 万美元。

1.5.4 Sample Test（□试样例）

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

(1) Do you ever feel overworked? (Why? /Why not?)

你是否曾感到工作过于疲劳？（为什么？）

(2) What problems do staff usually have when they are under the burden of a heavy workload?

如果员工的工作量过大，会产生什么问题？

(3) Do you think companies should provide sports facilities for their staff? (Why?)

你认为公司是否应该为其员工提供运动设施？（为什么？）

(4) What types of sports do you like watching or playing? (Why?)

你喜欢观看并参与什么样的体育运动？（为什么？）

Suggested answers

(1) Yes. Sometimes I am really overwhelmed with the heavy workload and feel tired and fatigued. As a secretary in the company, I have so much paperwork to do and often have to rush to meet tight deadlines. And I never seem to have time to take a holiday.

(No. I don't feel overworked though I have a heavy workload. As a salesman, I enjoy my work and feel happy every time I locate a contract. I always take time to relax myself: doing jogging regularly, going fishing at weekends. So I feel quite refreshed when I go back to my work.)

(2) When they are under the burden of a heavy workload, employees will often feel frustrated or depressed. This would result in stress-related illnesses, such as high blood pressure and fatigue. Employees will be in very low morale and give very poor performance in their work.

(If they are overworked, employees will be susceptible to stress-related illnesses, such as high blood pressure, ulcers, fatigue, etc. They will be in very bad mood and low spirits, and fail to meet their job requirements.)

(3) Yes. I think it's wise for companies to provide sports facilities for their staff. Employees can make the best use of these facilities to keep fit, so they can have better performance in their work. It's very rewarding.

(If all employees have easy access to sports facilities, both the staff and company will benefit. Sports activities not only enable employees to keep fit, but also generate team spirit and it's a great way to create a sense of common goals among staff.)

(4) My favourite sport is table tennis. It's a moderate exercise, but it requires great skills both tactical and technical. You have to have speed, stamina, dexterity, shrewdness and quickness in decision-making. It's the most popular sports game in China I think.

(Of all sport games, I like football most. It requires a great amount of skill combined with athletic ability, strength and creativity. It also requires accurate and quick

decision-making.)

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

Coping with a heavy workload

- benefits system
- time management
-

应对繁重的工作量需考虑哪些要点?

- 福利制度
- 时间管理
-

Suggested answer

In the face of a heavy workload, I think companies can introduce more benefits programmes. They can offer wellness and exercise programmes, and provide exercise facilities to enhance employees' health. They can also introduce more flexible benefits programmes like childcare and nursing care for aging parents, etc. so that employees can balance work and nonwork.

Time management is also important. Companies can provide training programs to help employees better manage their time. In this way, employees will become more organised and feel more at ease with their routine work.

Apart from these, companies should also care about the employees' mental health. They can provide psychological consultancy advice, so that employees can better adjust themselves to their work pressure.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Addressing the Problem of Overwork

Your manager has noticed the signs that employees in your company are overburdened with heavy workloads. You have been asked to make suggestions about how to improve this situation. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what signs of overwork do the staff show
- what measures should be taken to reduce stress at work

解决工作过劳的问题

你们的经理已经注意到了公司员工工作过劳的种种迹象。请你们提出改进这一情况的建议。讨论并决定:

- 员工表现出哪些过劳症状
- 应采取什么措施来减少工作压力

Suggested answer

- A: Well, I think employees in our company are overburdened though they do not tell you how they feel. But most of them show signs like consistently working late, working through lunch, coming to work even when ill, bringing work home, rushing to meet very tight deadlines and signs like... er...
- B: Like expressing frustration, feeling guilty when they leave work on time and not taking holidays.
- A: Yes. You're quite right.
- B: This situation has to be improved. You know, the consequences of this overload can be stress, burnout, and illness. For the company, it can result in high turnover and poor performance.
- A: So it's time we should get started with some downshifting plans to help our staff relax and get over stress from work.
- B: I think we can provide some flexible benefits to help employees balance their personal life and work. For example, we can offer childcare vouchers, retail vouchers, critical illness insurance and any... er, well, I mean annual leave.
- A: We should also provide some sports facilities and organise sports activities to enhance employees' health.
- B: That's a good idea. We can also provide coffee rooms and nutritious refreshments, so that our staff can relax themselves there during the break.
- A: I quite agree with you. And encouraging staff to take up a hobby is another way to get off the treadmill.
- B: Yes, recently, some other companies have organised "Joy Gang", to generate workplace fun. You see, laughter is the best medicine for those who are in low spirits. And it will help to boost the morale of our staff.
-

Follow-up questions

- (1) What facilities should companies provide in workplace to alleviate stress at work?
公司应该在工作场所提供什么设施来减轻员工的工作压力?
- (2) How important is it for employees to have time outside work?
员工在工作之余拥有闲暇时间有何重要性?
- (3) What other options are available to balance employees' work and life?
还有什么其他方法可以平衡员工的工作和生活?

- (4) Do you think time management helps to reduce stress at work? (Why?)
你认为时间管理可以减轻工作压力吗？（为什么？）
- (5) What are the major pay-backs of reducing stress of the overworked staff?
减轻员工的工作压力有什么主要益处？

Suggested answers

(1) Companies can provide childcare facilities, eldercare facilities or transportation facilities to help employees cope with these responsibilities, in this way, employees don't have to worry too much about these things, so they can take things easy.

(2) It's very important. You see, if they have more time outside work, they can relax, do physical exercises, take up hobbies, travel, etc. They will feel less stressed and happier both at work and at home.

(3) Companies can introduce flexible working, or flexitime or homeworking so that there's less conflict between work and home life.

(4) Certainly. If you can manage your time well, you can work more efficiently, and find more time to refresh yourself and you can retain a healthy balance between work and life.

(5) It's highly rewarding. It will benefit both the company and the employees. It helps employees to live a happier life and it also helps to boost their morale and enhance employee commitment to the company.

1.6 Work Environment

工作环境

1.6.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions（词语准备）

work environment 工作环境，亦作

working environment

wellbeing *n.* 利益，福利

sickness absence 病假

psychosocial *adj.* 社会心理的

job satisfaction 工作满意度

preconception *n.* 预想，先入为主的概念

effectivity *n.* 效率，功效

in the long run 长远来看

spectrum *n.* 范围，领域

stress medicine 应激医学

stimuli *n.* 刺激物，促进因素（为 stimulus 的复数形式）

chart *vt.* 详细计划、说明

holistic *adj.* 整体的，全盘的，整体

论的
 ensure worker comfort 保证工人的舒适度
 office appliances 办公设备
 copier *n.* 复印机
 fax machine *n.* 传真机
 out of date 过时
 service contract 服务合同
 obsolete *adj.* 过时的, 废弃的
 spatial design 空间设计
 accessible *adj.* 容易取得的, 容易接近的
 file system 文件橱柜
 surplus office supplies 多余的办公用品
 ambient light 背景光照明, 环境光照明
 task light 岗位操作照明
 work station 工作区
 defective illumination 不良照明
 a filing cabinet 文件橱柜
 over-3-day injury 请假三天以上的工伤
 computer cable 电脑线

telephone cord 电话线
 wiring *n.* 配线
 ream *n.* 令 (量词, 500 张纸为 1 令)
 Xerox paper 复印纸
 frayed *adj.* 磨损的
 tape down *vt.* 用带子捆住, 用胶布把……粘住
 rubber protector 橡胶防护罩, 橡胶保护装置
 tack down 钉住, 钉牢
 slip-resistant *adj.* 防滑的
 ventilation *n.* 通风
 sore throat 喉咙痛
 safety inspection 安全检查
 individual creativity 个人的创造力
 smoke detector (预报火警的) 烟雾探测器
 a working fire extinguisher 功能良好的灭火器
 acquaint sb. with sth. 让某人了解/熟悉……
 rules and regulations 规章制度

1.6.2 Background Information (相关背景知识)

工作环境

优美、安全的工作环境, 不仅是企业树立形象、增强凝聚力的需要, 也是企业改进生产效率、提高竞争力的基本条件。企业本着舒适、方便、卫生、安全、高效这几项要求, 依靠现代科学技术, 特别是建筑学、环境心理学、人类工效学、卫生学等学科的最新成就, 理性、科学地设计工作环境, 以满足现代工作空间的基本要求。对工作环境的关注在当今商业竞争日益激烈的情况下显得尤为重要, 因此, 各大企业本着人文主义的管理原则, 愿意出资改进其工作环境。

企业出于对员工安全的负责, 高度重视建筑防灾、装饰构造、绿色材料的使用、有毒有害气体的管理等环节, 努力为工作人员创造一个健康、卫生、安全的工作

作环境。同时，从工效学（Ergonomics）的角度出发，企业根据人的心理、生理、身体结构、工作性质等特点，充分考虑人在工作时的姿势、人体活动范围、动作节奏和速度，改进设备安置方式、办公家具及机器操作的舒适度等，为员工创造合理、方便的工作环境。企业还努力调整工作场所的温度、湿度、噪音、灯光照明、背景色彩、气味等环境细节，以减轻工作疲劳度，创造舒适、优美的工作环境，更大限度地提高员工的工作效率，使之为社会创造更多的财富。

1.6.3 Background Reading（相关背景阅读）

Office environment affects health, wellbeing and work

The way the workplace is designed has greater significance than we think. It affects health, wellbeing and work.

In Sweden, sickness absence has been high among the working population in recent years. Ill health has become a macroeconomic problem. Research shows that psychosocial environmental factors have a great influence on mental and physiological health, and we know that job satisfaction probably plays an important part in this context. Psychological ill health is the most common cause of sickness absence among office workers.

On the other hand, we know much less of how the physical office environment affects office workers and their job satisfaction. A research based design and construction process would be needed. The relationships among form, function and health and job satisfaction are complex. It is not enough to design office environments only on the basis of practical experience and professional preconceptions. Management wishes to have more interaction and information sharing among employees, so that creativity and effectivity at the workplace may be enhanced in this way and better results may be achieved in the long run.

Research concerning the influence of the physical environment on the individual has ranged over a broad spectrum. In environmental psychology, researchers have studied individual environmental factors, such as sound, to see how it affects the subjective perception of stress. The study shows that noise gives rise to dissatisfaction with the physical working environment.

Stress medicine has focused on how the body reacts to different stimuli in the environment. This research shows that a view of roads and traffic produces higher stress levels in the blood than a view of nature.

In management research there are studies which have attempted to chart the effect of the physical working environment on performance and efficiency. The results indicate that a

highly rated physical working environment results in greater job satisfaction.

In the area, architecture, that has a direct influence on the physical environment, there are few studies that show how design affects the end users.

In our opinion, it is important to bring together the different disciplines so that we may have an opportunity to measure and assess the influence of the physical office environment on the employees. In other words: an interdisciplinary approach is essential. It is also important to apply a holistic view to the office environment, since it is the totality of different factors that constitutes the actual office environment.

参考译文

办公环境影响员工健康、利益和工作

工作场所的设计要比我们想象的重要得多，它影响到员工的健康、利益和工作。

在瑞典，近年来工作人口中的病假率一直居高不下，员工疾病已经成为一个宏观的经济问题。研究表明，社会心理环境因素对员工的心理和生理健康影响甚大，我们认为，在这种情况下，工作满意度可能起到很重要的作用。在办公人员中，心理疾病是员工请病假的普遍原因。

尽管事实如此，对于办公环境如何影响办公人员以及他们的工作满意度，我们却知之甚少。有必要根据研究对办公场所进行设计和建构。办公场所的形式、功能和员工的健康、工作满意度之间有着十分复杂的关系，仅仅基于实际经验和专业设想来设计办公环境是不够的。管理层希望和员工分享更多的信息、进行更多的交流，这样，工作中的创造力和效率才能得到提高，从长远来看，工作才能取得更好的成果。

就物理环境对个人影响进行的研究已经涉及了很广的范畴。在环境心理学中，研究者研究了个人环境因素，如声音如何对个人的压力感产生影响。研究表明，噪声会使员工对工作的物理环境产生不满情绪。

应激医学关注人体如何对环境中的各种刺激因素产生反应。这一研究显示，当人们看到马路和行人车辆时，血液中的应激水平要比看到自然风景时更高。

在管理研究中，研究者试图就物理工作环境对绩效和工作效率的影响进行说明。研究结果表明，员工对工作环境的高度评价产生更高的工作满意度。

针对环境产生直接影响的地域、建筑进行的研究甚少，很少有研究表明地域、建筑设计对终端用户会产生什么影响。

我们认为，重要的是要融合不同的学科，这样我们就有机会来衡量和评估物理环境是如何影响员工的。换言之，关键是要运用一种跨学科的研究方法。重要的是，对于办公环境要采用整体论的方法来进行研究，因为实际的办公环境是由不同因素组合而构成的。

1.6.4 Sample Test（□试样例）

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) Why should companies create a pleasant working environment?
公司为什么需要营造舒适的工作环境？
- (2) How important is it to consider health and safety when planning workplace layout?
规划工作场所布局时，考虑健康和安全因素有什么重要性？
- (3) Do you think cost is the most important thing to consider when buying office furniture? (Why? /Why not?)
你认为购买办公家具时，费用是最主要的考虑因素吗？（为什么？）
- (4) Is it a good idea to rent office equipment instead of buying them? (Why? /Why not?)
租用而不是购买办公设备这样的想法好吗？（为什么？）

Suggested answers

(1) Companies should seek to create appealing working environment, so that employees will look forward to coming to work each day. And a business-casual professional environment enables employees to be more productive.

(2) Accidents can happen in the workplace and cause injuries to the employees. So companies have health and safety obligations and should take precautions to provide a safe work environment for their employees.

(3) No. I think the most important thing to consider is to ensure worker comfort, so as to minimize the drudgery of work and increase productivity.

(Yes. I think cost is the first thing to consider, particularly for small companies. You see, purchasing office appliances will cost them a great fortune. They really need to compare prices before they buy.)

(4) Yes. The speed of technological change is faster than ever, office equipment like copier, fax machines become out of date soon. So I think it's better to rent office equipment rather than buying them. What's more, you get the service contract when you

rent equipment.

(No. I think, companies have to buy basic, durable equipment that will last for years, such as desks, chairs, phones, etc., but they don't need to buy every piece of equipment, they can rent expensive, high-tech equipment that will soon become obsolete, for example computers, printers, fax machines, etc.)

Part Two : Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

设计办公室布局需考虑哪些要点?

Designing the layout of an office

- appropriate use of space
- amount of light
-

- 空间的合理使用
- 光线
-

Suggested answer

First of all, we have to consider spatial design when setting up office. We should establish primary and secondary work areas for paper work, computer activities and accessible file systems, and allocate space for storage of surplus office supplies. Make the best use of space and respect the privacy of our staff members.

Lighting is also critical. We should consider how much lighting and what type of lighting is needed to work more efficiently and effectively. Besides natural light, we also need to provide ambient light overhead and task light on work stations, as you see, defective illumination reduces work efficiency.

On top of that, when we're structuring the layout of our office, it's also important to consider health and safety, calculate future growth and space needs, and apply ergonomics to adapt work or working conditions to suit our staff.

Part Three : Collaborative Task and Discussion

Health and Safety Precautions

Two accidents happened in your office in the past year that resulted in bodily injuries to some staff members. Your line manager is revising health and safety precautions to eliminate the causes of office injuries. You have been asked to make suggestions. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what unsafe conditions there are in the office
- what precautions should be taken

健康和安全防范措施

去年你们办公室发生了两起事故，导致一些员工身体受伤。经理正在重新修订健康和安全防范措施以减少伤害。请你们就此提出建议。讨论并决定：

- 办公室中存在哪些不安全因素
- 应采取什么防范措施

Suggested answer

- A: You see, there were two over-3-day injuries in our office last year: Tom got his fingers broken when he slammed his fingers in the file drawer and Jane bumped her head over the edge of a filing cabinet and got a few stitches. It's really time we reconsidered our safety precautions.
- B: Yes. We need to make a checklist of unsafe conditions in the office. They might cause further injuries in our office. For example, our computer cables and telephone cords sprawl on the floor, and if anyone trips over them, they are likely to sprain ankles and backs or even worse, break their legs.
- A: And the wiring all clutter up on desks, that might spill cups of hot coffee or tea, someone might get burned.
- B: It's dangerous to stack reams of Xerox paper onto the filing cabinet, in case they fall, people nearby will be hurt. I have also noticed that some of our electrical cords are already frayed or cracked, it's most dangerous.
- A: Safety is our first priority. We should take measures immediately to eliminate these hazards. The first thing to do is to replace all frayed electrical cords, all electrical and telephone cords running into walk areas must be taped down or inserted through rubber protectors to prevent tripping hazards.
- B: Yes, wiring on the desks should be arranged neatly. And we should allocate special space for Xerox paper instead of stacking them high on the filing cabinet. For reaching high shelves, there should be a stable step stool with a handrail to grasp.
- A: Carpets in the office should be tacked down and slip-resistant, particularly in wet weather, to prevent any slipping or tripping accidents.
- B: You see we have to walk through a dark area before we reach the switch, so we should reinstall the switch to prevent tripping accident, and we should make sure that our work areas are well lighted.
- A: We also need to improve the ventilation in our office to help prevent headaches, smells, sore throats, stuffiness and dustiness. And at least one smoke detector

should be properly installed in the office.

B: You're right. A working fire extinguisher should be available to handle small fires, and all staff members should know how to use it. Finally, we must entrust a manager with safety responsibilities and conduct safety inspections regularly.

Follow-up questions

- (1) What are the advantages of a pleasant working environment?
提供良好的工作环境有什么好处?
- (2) What are the advantages and disadvantages of moving to new offices?
搬入新办公室有哪些好处和坏处?
- (3) Do you think employees work more efficiently in spacious offices? (Why?)
你是否认为员工在宽敞的办公室里工作效率会更高一些?(为什么?)
- (4) What should companies do to increase employees' work safety awareness?
公司应该采取什么措施来提高员工的安全意识?
- (5) In what ways will offices change in the future?
未来的办公室会有什么变化?

Suggested answers

(1) People will become more productive and efficient in pleasant work environment, and good working conditions will help to bring out individual creativity.

(2) The advantages include better working conditions, more spacious and pleasant environment. The disadvantages are: you're not used to the new environment and the newly furnished office might be toxic and harmful to health.

(3) Of course. I think a spacious office is conducive to having fun in the work while the employees become more productive and maintain quality and effectiveness of work.

(4) Companies should offer training programmes and acquaint their employees with work safety rules and regulations. All employees must be given safety information and accident prevention instructions.

(5) In the future, I think all office equipment will be digitalized and work efficiency will be further improved. Or perhaps staff members can make better use of the Internet and work at home, I think home offices will be popular.

1.7 Logistics

物流

1.7.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions（词语准备）

logistics strategy 物流战略

logistics system 物流系统

tangible product 有形产品

intangible product 无形产品

encompass *vt.* 包含，包括

transport of goods 货物运输

multifaceted *adj.* 多方面的

for-profit industry 营利行业

non-profit organisation 非营利性机构

final goods 成品，亦作 finished goods

the end of the production line 生产终端

physical distribution 销售物流（简称 PD）

embrace *vt.* 包含，包括

material management 材料管理

supply chain 供应链

domestically *adv.*（合乎）国内地

logistics management services 物流管理服务

raw material acquisition 原料采购

inventory management 库存管理

shipment of goods 发货服务，货物

运输

sustainability *n.* 可持续性

customer satisfaction survey 顾客满意度调查

front-line *adj.* 前线的，第一线的

information management 信息管理

specification *n.* 详细说明书，清单

deliver *vt.* 提供，供给

pipeline *n.* 渠道，传送途径

order-processing 订单处理

warehouse management 仓库管理

inventory *n.* 存货，财产清册

procurement *n.* 采购，调拨，调配

misstep *n.* 失策，错误

target market 目标市场

have impact on 对……有影响

social values 社会价值观

become sensitive to 对……敏感

mindset *n.* 思想倾向，心态

open-minded *adj.* 胸怀宽广的

cultural taboo 文化禁忌

perspective *n.* 观点，视点，看法

1.7.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

什么叫“物流”

物流在英语中有两个词，一个是 Physical Distribution（PD，意为“销售物流”）；另一个是 Logistics。这两个英语名词基本同时出现在 20 世纪 30 ~ 40 年代，

但角度不同,范围有别,强调的内容也相异。

“物流”这一概念最早出现在美国,当时英文是 Physical Distribution (PD)。1935 年美国销售协会对“PD”进行了定义:“PD 是指从生产到消费,在物质资料的销售和服务过程中所伴随的经济活动。”

第二次世界大战期间,美国根据军事上的需要,在军火和军需品的战时供应中,运用后勤管理(Logistics Management)方法,对军火的运输、补给、屯驻、调配等进行全面管理。那时的“Logistics”主要是指将战时物资装备的生产、采购、运输、配给等活动作为一个整体进行运作,以保证物资装备补给费用最低、速度最快、服务最好,从而保证战争的胜利。

第二次世界大战后,“Logistics”逐渐形成了一门单独的管理科学,并不断发展为“后勤工程”(Logistics Engineering)、“后勤分配”(Logistics of Distribution)等后勤管理的各个领域。随后,企业界便将“Logistics”这种有效的后勤管理系统引入到企业经营当中,以寻求企业的物流也能像军队的兵站后勤那样科学管理、高效运营。后来,鉴于“Logistics”概念比“PD”概念更能表达出现代综合物流的全部内涵,人们开始采用“Logistics”来替代“PD”。1998 年美国物流管理协会又一次对物流下了如下定义:“物流是供应链流程的一部分,是为了满足客户需求而对商品、服务及相关信息从原产地到消费地的高效率、高效益的正向和反向流动及储存进行的计划、实施与控制过程。”

军事后勤为部队和战争服务,工业后勤为制造业的生产和经营服务,商业后勤则为商业运行和顾客服务;因此,物流的核心观念是服务观念。

目前国际上物流业正在向信息化方向发展,“物流”的定义已经扩展到了更为广阔的范畴,包括与“物流”密切相关的金融、咨询、管理、电子信息处理等各种活动。现代物流充分运用信息技术,将运输、仓储、装卸、加工、整理、配送、信息等各个环节有机地结合起来,形成完整的供应链,为用户提供多功能、一体化的综合服务。

1.7.3 Background Reading (相关背景阅读)

Logistics: the Modern Perspective

At its heart, logistics deals with satisfying the customer. This implies that management must first understand what those requirements are before a logistics strategy can be developed and implemented to meet them. Customer service is the most important output of an organisation's logistics system.

In a more practical sense, logistics refers to the systematic management of the various

activities required to move benefits from their point of production to the customer. Often these benefits are in the form of a tangible product that must be manufactured and moved to the user; sometimes these benefits are intangible and are known as services. They too must be produced and made available to the final customer. But logistics encompasses much more than just the transport of goods. The concept of benefits is a multifaceted one that goes beyond the product or service itself to include issues regarding timing, quantity, supporting services, location and cost. So a basic definition of logistics is the continuous process of meeting customer needs by ensuring the availability of the right benefits for the right customer, in the quantity and condition desired by that customer, at the time and place the customer wants them, all for a price the buyer is willing to pay. These concepts apply equally well to for-profit industries and non-profit organisations.

However, logistics can mean different things to different organisations. Some firms are more concerned with producing the benefits; their management focus is on the flow of raw materials into the production process rather than on delivering the final goods to the user. Some companies are much more concerned with the flow of finished goods from the end of the production line to the customer. Logistics in this situation is sometimes referred to as physical distribution. Finally, some firms view logistics as embracing both material management and physical distribution. This broader view of logistics integrates materials management and physical distribution tasks into a single supply chain that links the customer with all aspects of the firm, sometimes it is referred to as supply chain management.

参考译文

物流的现代含义

物流的核心是让客户满意。这意味着管理层在开发、实施物流战略之前必须首先了解客户的各种需求。客户服务是企业物流体系最重要的内容。

从更加实际的意义上看，在将生产产生的利益转移给客户的过程中，涉及诸多不同环节，物流就是指对这些环节进行系统化管理。通常这些利益是指有形产品，需要把它们生产出来并运达用户；有时这些利益是无形的产品，指各种服务。这些服务也需要生产出来并把它们提供给终端客户。但是物流所涵盖的绝不仅仅是货物的运输。利益这一概念含义广泛，它超越了产品和服务本身，包含了时间调配、数量、辅助服务、地点和成本等问题。因此物流的基本定义是：按客

户愿意支付的价格，在客户期望的时间和地点，以客户期望的数量和条件确保为适当的客户提供适当的利益，从而满足客户需求的持续过程。这些理念同样适用于营利性和非营利性组织。

然而，对于不同的组织，物流的内涵是不同的。有些企业更注重生产利益：它们的管理重点是从原材料到产品的过程，而非将成品运送到客户的过程。有些企业则更关注从生产线终端到客户端的成品流程。在这种情况下，物流仅指产品分销。最后，还有一些企业把物流看做是材料管理和产品分销的融合。这种广义上的物流概念将材料管理和产品分销等任务整合成一个单一的供应链，把客户和企业的各个方面连接在一起，有时物流被看做是供应链管理。

1.7.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) What do you think logistics management services involve?
你认为物流管理服务包含哪些内容?
- (2) Is it important for managers of global organisations to understand logistics? (Why?)
跨国企业的经理了解物流有什么重要性? (为什么?)
- (3) What do you think companies can do to improve their customer service?
公司可以采取什么措施来改进客户服务?
- (4) Do you think you would like to work in customer services? (Why? /Why not?)
你愿意在客户服务部门工作吗? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) Logistics management services mainly involve: raw material acquisition, inventory management, warehousing services, goods packaging, shipment of goods and communication. These operations are essential for the productive sustainability of businesses.

(2) Managers of global organisations are faced with the challenge to expand their markets beyond their home borders. Naturally, logistics becomes even more critical to the firm's success globally than it is domestically. To improve their operational efficiency, they have to understand logistics.

(3) Companies can regularly conduct customer satisfaction surveys to get necessary feedback on their services, so that they know the needs and expectations of their customers.

ers. And they can also implement a system to monitor the performance of their employees and reward outstanding performers to maintain high level customer service.

(4) Yes. I think I'm the right person to be a front-line service employee. First of all, I like to take challenging jobs, I mean, to communicate face to face with customers is a rather challenging one. And secondly, I'm a very active yet patient person, good at interacting with people. Finally, by working front-line, I'm able to influence the decisions of our customers.

(No. I'm afraid working in customer services really does not quite suit me. You see, I'm not a very outgoing person and am not quite good at interacting with people. Besides, I'm not very good at expressing myself. Sometimes I find it difficult to put my ideas across.)

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

制定物流策略需考虑哪些要点？

Developing logistics strategies

- customer service levels
- information management
-

- 客户服务水平
- 信息管理
-

Suggested answers

Well, you see, customer service is actually where supply chain management or logistics starts. Customer service sets the specification for logistics system design. Because next to product quality, customer service is another important factor why customers decide to do business with you. You have to know exactly the needs and expectations of your customers, so that you can design the logistics system necessary to deliver the required level of service.

Logistics is about managing the flow of materials and the flow of information. Decisions cannot be made without having appropriate information. And information is also important in tracking product flow through the logistics pipelines. So designing and implementing information systems to support the logistics network is critical.

To ensure logistics success, you also need to consider other factors like order-processing, warehouse management, inventory and materials management, procurement, transportation, etc.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Cultural Issues in Global Logistics

The company you work for is relocating some logistics managers abroad and is designing a training course for them on cultural issues in logistics. You have been asked to advise on this training course. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- how important it is to consider cultural differences in the logistics process
- what cultural aspects should be included in the training course

国际物流中的文化问题

你们公司拟调派一些物流经理到国外工作，现正在就物流中的文化问题为他们设计培训课程。请你们为这一培训课程提出建议。讨论并决定：

- 物流过程中考虑文化差异的重要性
- 培训课程中应包含哪些文化因素

Suggested answers

- A: When doing business internationally, it's very easy to take a misstep if you don't understand the culture of the target market.
- B: Yes. Cultural differences can add layers of challenges to global logistics and supply chain management. If companies aim to become competent globally, they have to take cultural differences into consideration. Logistics managers must understand the cultural make-up of the customers that comprise the markets.
- A: Yes. Cultural differences have impact on different areas of logistics. For example, people from different cultural backgrounds have different working styles, and in going global, you need to learn their ways of looking at things and their ways of interpreting business relationships.
- B: Yes. Understanding the needs of customers in each market is essential in logistics success. But we can't just throw our logistics experts into another country without training them. You see, no matter how smart they are, they will make all sorts of mistakes unless they become sensitive to cultural differences.
- A: Certainly. We should focus our training programme on promoting the global mind-set, being open-minded and tolerant of a different culture is the most important thing.
- B: We should include training items on thought patterns, buyer-seller relationships, shopping habits, etc.
- A: Of course, logistics system can't clash with the culture of the target market and

respect for the native culture is extremely important. So we also need to consider cultural taboos. For example, in countries like Japan and China, customers don't like goods packed in four together, as "four" is regarded as an unlucky number.

B: You're right. Different shopping habits should also be included in our training programme. In some countries, people rely on public transportation, so goods must come in small packages that can be easily carried on the bus. But in countries where people rely on personal automobiles, goods in large packages are more attractive.

A: Besides that, we should also acquaint our logistics professionals with differences in language, laws and social customs.

Follow-up questions

(1) Is it a good idea for companies to provide cultural training courses to their employees? (Why? /Why not?)

公司为其雇员提供文化方面的培训课程好不好? (为什么?)

(2) Is it important for companies to anticipate cultural barriers in their services? (Why? /Why not?)

公司在服务中预想到文化障碍的存在是否重要? (为什么?)

(3) Do you think that in future English will become the official language of the business world? (Why? /Why not?)

你认为今后英语是否会成为商界的正式通用语言? (为什么?)

(4) How important is it for employees in multinational companies to learn a foreign language?

跨国公司的员工学习外语有何重要性?

(5) What should companies do to improve staff awareness of cultural differences?

公司应采用什么方法来提高员工的文化差异意识?

Suggested answers

(1) Yes. Cultural training courses can help employees find out differences among people, including cultural, historical, language, laws and social values. Understanding differences can enhance mutual trust. It's important in promoting business abroad.

(2) Sure. If companies are sensitive to cultural differences and can anticipate cultural barriers in international business, they would be more prepared for any possible difficulties and would certainly become globally competent.

(3) I think it will. As a matter of fact, more and more multinational companies use English as their official corporate language nowadays. English has become an international language.

(4) Learning a foreign language enables people to be more open-minded, to see things in the perspectives of other people. And that would enhance cultural exchange and promote mutual understanding.

(5) Companies can offer cultural training courses or foreign language courses to their employees. Or they can also design some exchange programmes, or relocate some of their employees to work abroad.

1.8 Business Ethics

商业道德

1.8.1 Preparation: Words and Expressions (词语准备)

credo *n.* 信条

contradiction *n.* 矛盾

integrity *n.* 诚信, 正直

pharmaceutical *adj.* 制药的

place a high priority on... 对……高度重视

over-the-counter 非处方(药), 无须医生处方就可出售的

analgesic *n.* 止痛剂

subsidiary *n.* 子公司

executive *n.* 主管人员, 执行官

dilemma *n.* 进退两难的局面, 困难的选择

recall *vt.* 召回

contaminate *vt.* 污染

the public 公众

off-chance 万分之一的可能

tamper-resistant *adj.* 可抗不良物质掺入的(包装)

tamperproof *adj.* 可防不良物质掺入的(包装)

capsule *n.* 胶囊

cyanide *n.* 氰化物

caplet *n.* 囊片(指为防止不良物质掺入而设计的一种椭圆胶囊形糖衣药片)

touch off 引发

fraud *n.* 欺骗, 欺诈

tax-avoidance *n.* 逃税

offer bribery 行贿

take bribery 受贿

secret commission 私拿回扣

insider trading 内幕交易

erode *vt.* 侵蚀, 腐蚀

corporate performance 企业运作, 亦作 company performance

turnover *n.* 营业额

dividend *n.* 红利, 股息

workplace ethics 职业道德, 职场道德

code of ethics 道德准则，道德规范

confectionary *n.* 糖果厂

gel candy *n.* 果冻（糖果）

hit the headlines 成为头条新闻

safety notice 安全告示

dissolve *vt.* 溶解，融化

ingredient *n.* 成分

competitive advantage 竞争优势

shop floor *n.* （总称）工人

boardroom *n.* （总称）董事会

Corporate Social Responsibility 企业的
社会责任（简称 CSR）

well-being *n.* 利益，福利

clash *vt.* 冲突

let alone 更不用说

Johnson & Johnson 美国强生公司（简
称 J & J）

1.8.2 Background Information（相关背景知识）

商业道德

商业道德是指公认的道德规范在具体商业情景和商业活动中的应用。商业道德从分析商业的本质、商务活动的前期行为入手，为人们提供了判断商务活动是否符合道德规范的商业道德行为准则。

在商务决策和运作过程中，越来越多的企业遇到了这样的问题：环保问题、诚信问题、公司裁员问题、企业的社会责任（CSR）问题、职员的隐私和权利问题、多元化的价值观和对文化传统的尊重问题、跨国公司逃税和贿赂问题、不公平竞争问题等。因此，遵守商业道德成为了企业经营方式的重要环节。企业遵守商业道德的前提是企业做决策时抱着对社会负责的态度，同时企业遵守商业道德也会优化企业的公众形象，有利于获得客户、组织和政府的信任和赞许，获得更多有利的社会资源。

恪守商业道德成为企业文化的核心价值观，也是企业生存与发展的基本准则。不少公司企业已经制定出明晰的道德信条，详细地勾勒出公司应有的社会责任的内涵，并将其加以制度化，使该信条成为公司日常经营哲学的一部分予以贯彻实施。

目前在西方，商业道德，特别是企业的社会责任这一主题，已经被纳入主流商业教育，成为大学本科生和工商管理硕士（MBA）的必修课程，从中可见商业道德受重视的程度。

1.8.3 Background Reading（相关背景阅读）

What Do Business Ethics Bring to J & J

To some people, the concept of business ethics may be a contradiction. In other

words, they may view business managers as responsible only for making profits, not for upholding standards of integrity. But in two major company crises, the international pharmaceutical company Johnson & Johnson found that placing a high priority on ethics can turn out to be good for business.

Tyienol is a leading over-the-counter analgesic produced by a subsidiary of Johnson & Johnson. When people who took Tyienol to relieve pain ended up dying from the product, J & J executives were faced with a dilemma: should they spend millions to recall the product and perhaps encourage similar crimes, or should they simply replace the product in people's homes and hope that no other bottles of Tyienol were contaminated? The answer came from the company's credo. J & J President David Clare stated: "First and foremost, we had to protect the public." To do this, the company withdrew millions of bottles and replaced millions more without cost to the customer, on the off-chance that other bottles might be poisoned.

After the first crisis, the U. S. Federal Drug Administration imposed new regulations to make drug packaging tamper-resistant. No packaging, however, can be tamperproof, which was sadly proven by the second crisis. Another person died from swallowing Tyienol capsules laced with cyanide. At this point, J & J executives were again guided by their company credo. They imposed their own higher standard, and changed from making capsules to caplets, in order to provide a safer product.

Both crises touched off a debate on business ethics and integrity. Yet, after each one, J & J executives managed to restore public confidence and Tyienol made a comeback. J & J showed the public that it cared about the customer, and the product increased its market share.

参考译文

商业道德给强生公司带来了什么

对有些人来说,商业道德这一概念可能是矛盾的。也就是说,他们可能认为商界经理们只负责创造利润,而没有责任来维护诚信标准。但跨国制药企业强生公司却在两次重大企业危机中发现,高度重视道德标准会带来对其经营有利的结果。

泰诺胶囊是强生公司的一个下属企业生产的一线非处方止痛药。当有人服用此药来止痛却导致死亡时,强生公司的主管人员面临两难困境:是应该花费上百万美元召回该产品,但有可能怂恿类似(投毒)犯罪;还是仅仅替换人们家中

的药品，侥幸地希望其他泰诺止痛药未受污染？解决问题的答案来自于强生公司的信条。强生公司总裁大卫·克莱尔声明：“最重要的是，我们必须保护公众。”为此，公司收回了数以百万计的止痛药，此外，为避免其他药片也有万分之一被污染的可能，还免费为消费者替换了数百万盒的药片。

第一次危机后，美国药品管理局强制推行了新的规章以防止药品包装被人做手脚。然而，没有哪种包装是万无一失的，令人难过的是，这在第二次危机中得到了验证。又有一人因为服用掺有氰化物的泰诺胶囊而死于非命。此时，强生公司的主管人员又一次依照公司信条行事。他们强制实施了自己制定的更为严格的标准，将胶囊改为可防不良物质掺入的胶囊形糖衣片，以提供更为安全的产品。

这两次危机都引发了关于商业道德和诚信的辩论。但是每次危机发生后，强生公司的主管人员都能够重获公众的信任，泰诺止痛片又重返市场。强生公司让公众看到了他们对消费者的关怀，该产品的市场份额也得到了提高。

（注：强生公司泰诺药片中毒事件

1982年9月，美国芝加哥发生有人因服用含氰化物的泰诺止痛胶囊中毒死亡的严重事故。随即泰诺生产商强生公司迅速采取了一系列有效措施，并遵循公司的道德信条，以公众和消费者利益为重，不惜斥巨资在最短时间内从各大药店收回了所有的这种药，并花50万美元向有关的医生、医院和经销商发出警报。

事故发生前，泰诺在美国成人止痛药市场中占有35%的份额，年销售额高达4.5亿美元，占强生公司总利润的15%。事故发生后，泰诺的市场份额曾一度下降。但当强生公司得知事态已稳定，并且向药片投毒的人已被拘留时，并没有将产品马上投入市场。当时美国药品管理局制定了新的药品安全法，要求药品生产企业采用“无污染包装”。强生公司立即率先响应新规定，结果在价值12亿美元的止痛片市场上挤走了它的竞争对手，仅用5个月的时间就夺回了原市场份额的70%。

一场“灭顶之灾”竟奇迹般地为强生公司赢得了更高的声誉，这归功于强生公司在危机管理中恪守其以人为本、以消费者利益为重的道德信条，成功地向公众传达了企业的社会责任感，受到了消费者的欢迎和认可。）

下面是强生公司于1943年制定的公司信条，充分体现了该公司恪守商业道德的原则：

Our Credo

We believe our first responsibility is to the doctors, nurses and patients,
to mothers and fathers and all others who use our products and services.

In meeting their needs everything we do must be of high quality.

We must constantly strive to reduce our costs
in order to maintain reasonable prices.

Customers' orders must be serviced promptly and accurately.

Our suppliers and distributors must have an opportunity
to make a fair profit.

We are responsible to our employees,
the men and women who work with us throughout the world.
Everyone must be considered as an individual.

We must respect their dignity and recognize their merit.

They must have a sense of security in their jobs.

Compensation must be fair and adequate,
and working conditions clean, orderly and safe.

We must be mindful of ways to help our employees fulfill
their family responsibilities.

Employees must feel free to make suggestions and complaints.

There must be equal opportunity for employment, development
and advancement for those qualified.

We must provide competent management,
and their actions must be just and ethical.

We are responsible to the communities in which we live and work
and to the world community as well.

We must be good citizens—support good works and charities
and bear our fair share of taxes.

We must encourage civic improvements and better health and education.

We must maintain in good order
the property we are privileged to use,
protecting the environment and natural resources.

Our final responsibility is to our stockholders.

Business must make a sound profit.

We must experiment with new ideas.

Research must be carried on, innovative programs developed
and mistakes paid for.

New equipment must be purchased, new facilities provided and new products launched.

Reserves must be created to provide for adverse times.

When we operate according to these principles, the stockholders should realize a fair return.

参考译文

我们的信条

我们相信我们首先要对医生、护士和病人，
对父母亲以及所有使用我们的产品和接受我们服务的人负责。
为了满足他们的需求，我们所做的一切都必须都是高质量的。
我们必须不断地致力于降低成本，以保持合理的价格。
客户的订货必须迅速而准确地供应。
我们的供应商和经销商应该有机会获得合理的利润。
我们要对世界各地和我们一起共事的男女同仁们负责。
每一位同仁都应被视为独立的个体。
我们必须维护他们的尊严，赞赏他们的优点。
要使他们对其工作有一种安全感。
薪酬必须公平合理，
工作环境必须清洁、整齐和安全。
我们必须设法帮助员工履行他们对家庭的责任。
必须让员工在提出建议和申诉时畅所欲言。
对于合格的人员必须给予平等的聘用、发展和升迁的机会。
我们必须具备称职的管理人员，
他们的行为必须公正并符合道德规范。
我们要对我们所生活和工作的社会、对整个世界负责。
我们必须做好公民——支持对社会有益的活动和慈善事业，
缴纳我们应付的税款。
我们必须鼓励全民进步，促进健康和教育事业的发展。
我们必须很好地维护我们所使用的财产，
保护环境和自然资源。

最后，我们要对全体股东负责。

企业经营必须获得合理的利润。

我们必须尝试新的构想。

必须坚持研究工作，开发革新项目，

承担错误的代价并加以改正。

必须购置新设备，提供新设施，推出新产品。

必须设立储备金，以备不时之需。

如果我们依照这些原则进行经营，

股东们就会获得合理的回报。

1.8.4 Sample Test (□试样例)

Part One: Interview

Interlocutor's questions

- (1) Do you think companies should place high priority on business ethics? (Why? / Why not?)

你认为公司应该高度重视商业道德吗？(为什么?)

- (2) Is it necessary for every company to have clearly stated business ethics? (Why? / Why not?)

是否每家公司都有必要制定明确的商业道德标准？(为什么?)

- (3) How important is integrity in business operation?

诚信在商业运作中有多重要?

- (4) What are the usual unethical behaviour in business activities?

商务活动中不诚实的常见表现有哪些?

Suggested answers

(1) Yes. Companies should follow moral principles when they conduct business, because their decisions can affect society, and they have responsibility to their customers, employees, stockholders and creditors, etc. So operating in an ethical manner is essential to company success.

(2) It is essential that every company should establish a specific code of business ethics and responsibilities that sets guidelines for business activities. All employees must keep that in mind and constantly apply it to the performance of all activities for the company.

(3) Companies should apply the highest standards of integrity to everything they do. You see, without integrity, a company cannot possibly gain the trust of customers,

clients and the public, as a result, it will certainly fail to survive in this highly competitive age.

(4) Major unethical behaviour in business include fraud, tax-avoidance cheating, lying and corrupt practices like offering and taking bribery, secret commissions, insider trading, etc. These things erode the principle of integrity that lies at the heart of our business organisations.

Part Two: Mini-presentation

What's important when...?

衡量企业绩效需考虑哪些要点?

Measuring corporate performance

- workplace ethics
- social responsibility
-

- 职场道德
- 社会责任
-

Suggested answer

Well, measuring company performance is not just a case of looking at turnover, profits and dividends. We should also evaluate it in terms of workplace ethics. Code of ethics is the core of company culture and is an important tool for companies striving for long-term prospects and growth. Because workplace ethics inspire communication between employees, allow for respect to be extended to each person within the organization, and promote customer relationships that are based on honesty and integrity.

Business activities can have social impacts. Companies have the social responsibility to protect the environment. We should also see if companies have tried their best to mitigate their own environmental impacts, for instance, to see if they have tried their best to minimise waste in their operations and efficient management of resources.

Besides these, it's also important to examine if the company has conducted their business with integrity and in compliance with applicable laws and regulatory requirements.

Part Three: Collaborative Task and Discussion

Solving the Food Safety Crisis

The confectionary you work for is now facing a serious safety crisis: a small kid was choked on the gel candies you have marketed to children. You have been asked to help solve the problem. Discuss the situation together, and decide:

- what should be done with it
- how to improve the product

解决食品安全危机

你们所在的糖果厂正面临着严峻的安全危机：一个小孩食用你们专为儿童生产的果冻时被噎住了，请你们协助解决这一问题。讨论并决定：

- 公司应该做些什么
- 如何改进该产品

Suggested answer

- A: I'm most sorry to hear that a five-year-old girl was choked yesterday on our gel candy. Thank goodness she didn't die.
- B: Yes. The choking hazard hit the headlines, and everybody is talking about that. We should do something immediately.
- A: I'm quite with you. First of all, we should go visit the girl, offer compensation to her parents, and of course, bring some gifts to the poor girl.
- B: Yes. We should stop selling the candies immediately, I mean, to recall all the product from the market to prevent possible tragedies. We should also warn people and ask them to get rid of the product, particularly those small grocery stores that may stock the candies.
- A: You're right. It's really time we re-examine the safety of our product. You see, the candy that the girl choked on is our new product, the sweet gel that comes with a piece of fruit inside a shell of jelly.
- B: Yes, I see. We should add choking safety notices on the labels of our products, just to warn parents of choking dangers.
- A: Well, it doesn't help much I'm afraid. As a manufacturer, we're entirely responsible for that accident, we should seek to improve our products. You know, the gel in the candy doesn't readily dissolve, so it's not safe for young children. We should replace the gel with some other ingredient.
- B: Oh I see, that's really a good idea, and the piece of fruit should be chopped into bits. In this way, it will certainly prevent risks for choking injury and death. I always believe that food producers could save the lives of dozens of kids each year by turning out safer products.
- A: And I think the packing also needs to be improved. Our gel candy is packed in a small, soft plastic cup, but the size of the gel is a bit too small, the kids can just readily swallow it. We should make it larger, so that it will take a few bites to eat it up.

B: Or the parents can cut it up for small kids.

Follow-up questions

- (1) How important is the issue of ethics in the workplace?
工作中的道德问题有何重要性?
- (2) What should be done to ensure that all company staff follow the code of conduct set by the company?
公司如何保证所有员工遵循公司制定的道德规范?
- (3) What do you think integrity will bring to the company?
你认为诚信会给公司带来什么?
- (4) What corporate responsibility objectives should companies set for themselves?
公司应该给自己制定什么责任目标?
- (5) Do you think emphasizing business ethics is contradictory to making profits?
(Why?)
你认为强调商业道德和创造利润相互冲突吗? (为什么?)

Suggested answers

(1) The issue of ethics in the workplace is of vital importance. In today's competitive market, any company without a coherent ethics policy cannot possibly survive, they would certainly lose their competitive advantage to their rivals.

(2) The issue of ethics should be put into company development programmes for all employees, from the shop floor to the boardroom. Companies need to offer training courses, lectures, case analysis to make sure that all staff act in compliance with the highest standards.

(3) Integrity will surely create wealth. If you act with integrity in business, you can enjoy good reputation and a good public image. That would keep good people in your employ, and keep customers coming back for your products or services.

(4) Companies should not just seek profits only, they also have social obligations, or what is called Corporate Social Responsibility. They should be concerned with the well-being of the society, they're responsible for environmental protection and upholding the principle of integrity.

(5) No. I don't think business and ethics clash. Indeed, good ethics means good management. If companies ignore moral concerns, violate laws, or act unethically, they cannot possibly survive, let alone making any profits.
